

Discipleship

JCS

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Part I

Premarital Coaching

2 Catching Foxes

Pre-engagement counseling - start working on critical issues now, and plan to resolve them prior to engagement

History (of yourself and spouse) provides context:

- Gives you perspective
- Allows you to understand each others' vulnerabilities

2.1 Chapter 1 - Personal History

Gospel is the power of God for salvation Rom 1:16

Scripture allows us to :

- Interpret our history truthfully
- Respond to our history triumphantly
- Behold the glory of Christ shining through

God uses our experiences for our good

- Experiences do not control us
- God controls our life and destiny

II Cor 5:14 For the love of Christ controls us, because we have concluded this: that one has died for all, therefore all have died;

History does not determine who you are, but has influenced the way you think, feel, and live and have impacted your view of the world.

Questions for Chapter 1

- Tell us the story of you two meeting, courting, and engagement.
- Share your personal testimony
- *What did you learn about marriage from your family of origin that you'd like to emulate?*
- *What would you like to do differently?*

- How do your ancestors show up in your life?
- What are some spiritual challenges of this season of your lives?

Chapter 10 discussion will be a discussion about sexual purity and intimacy. You will need to have these discussions with one another to be ready for marriage.

- *Commitment to purity (victories, struggles)?*
- *Have you talked about past sexual sin, abuse, involvement?*

Now is the time to be honest. Hiding from people now will only make it more difficult to expose and face truth later. If you have a relevant sexual history, then please share enough of your history to bring into the light the sins and struggles that should be in the light.

“Facilitating a process of discovery”

2.2 Chapter 2

Framework for seeing marriage within a larger context:

- Christ-centered
- God-exalting
- Spirit-dependent

Creation- Designed to display and share his glory

Ps 19:1-6 The heavens are telling of his glory

Col 1:16-17 For by him all things were created, in heaven and on earth, visible and invisible, whether thrones or dominions or rulers or authorities—all things were **created through him and for him**. And he is before all things, and in him all things hold together.

Our personal lives are part of God’s redemptive plan

I Cor 10:31 Whether, then, you eat or drink or whatever you do, do all to the glory of God

Eph 1:4-6 even as he chose us in him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and blameless before him. In love he predestined us for adoption to himself as sons through Jesus Christ, according to the purpose of his will, **to the praise of his glorious grace**, with which he has blessed us in the Beloved.

I Tim 1:15-17 ¹⁵ The saying is trustworthy and deserving of full acceptance, that Christ Jesus came into the world to save sinners, of whom I am the foremost. ¹⁶ But I received mercy for this reason, that in me, as the foremost, Jesus Christ might display his perfect patience as an example to those who were to believe in him for eternal life. ¹⁷ To the King of the ages, immortal, invisible, the only God, be honor and glory forever and ever.

⇒ Paul was saved not only for his sake, but for God's glory and eternal purposes

Acts 17:24-28: ²⁴ The God who made the world and everything in it, being Lord of heaven and earth, does not live in temples made by man, ²⁵ nor is he served by human hands, as though he needed anything, since he himself gives to all mankind life and breath and everything. ²⁶ And he made from one man every nation of mankind to live on all the face of the earth, having determined allotted periods and the boundaries of their dwelling place, ²⁷ that they should seek God, and perhaps feel their way toward him and find him. Yet he is actually not far from each one of us, ²⁸ for

“‘In him we live and move and have our being’ as even some of your own poets have said, “‘For we are indeed his offspring.’

⇒ We are created to worship and enjoy God

2.2.1 Questions:

What did God have in mind when he created us?

Page 47 - Question #4 “What does means to seek Christ and his Kingdom *now* in your life? ..in your relationship?

Now that you are contemplating marriage, has that answer changed for you?

What does it mean to glorify God in your marriage?

What do you think God had in mind when he created the two of you and brought you together?

Is there an area of your relationship that brings frustration, bitterness, or disappointment?

What's it going to take to address this?

- God needs to intervene?
- My partner needs to change?
- I'm with the wrong person?

- It will always be this way?
- $\Rightarrow$. If this is the case, it's because you are not seeking God above all else.
- This exposes our lack of trust of God in this are
- Marriage will *expose* sin and weakness you didn't think were there

2.3 Chapter 3

Gen 1:26-27: ⁶ Then God said, "Let us make man in our image, after our likeness. And let them have dominion over the fish of the sea and over the birds of the heavens and over the livestock and over all the earth and over every creeping thing that creeps on the earth."

So God created man in his own image,
in the image of God he created him;
male and female he created them.

- 1: We are purposed by God to exist
 - 2: He decided in his mind to form the world and created us in his likeness
 - 3: God declared the creation of humans as good.
- $\Rightarrow$ Every person has God-designed beauty - dignity

Learn to seek God above all else

Learn to be satisfied in Jesus

2.3.1 Adam and Eve Prior to the Fall

Gen 2:20 But for Adam no suitable helper was found. ²¹ So the Lord God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and then closed up the place with flesh. ²² Then the Lord God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man. ²³ The man said, "This is now bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh; she shall be called 'woman,' for she was taken out of man." ²⁴ That is why a man leaves his father and mother and is united to his wife, and they become one flesh. ²⁵ Adam and his wife were both naked, and they felt no shame.

- Joy
- United
- Without shame (and naked together - ask your parents)
- Enjoyng relationship with God (waking together in the cool of the day - extra credit)

2.3.2 Adam and Eve After the Fall

Gen 3:1-20

Gen 3:8 Then the man and his wife heard the sound of the Lord God as he was walking in the garden in the cool of the day, and they hid from the Lord God among the trees of the garden. ⁹ But the Lord God called to the man, “Where are you?” ¹⁰ He answered, “I heard you in the garden, and I was afraid because I was naked; so I hid.” ¹¹ And he said, “Who told you that you were naked? Have you eaten from the tree that I commanded you not to eat from?” ¹² The man said, “The woman you put here with me—she gave me some fruit from the tree, and I ate it.”

- Fear
- Shame (hiding from one another)
- Blame
- Hiding from God
- Attempted to cover their own sin

2.3.3 FALLEN NATURE

Gen 3:6-7

We revolted → humanity died

We began running from God rather than to God

Sinful nature is more than a history of sin

We have adopted a way of Life that devalues God and exalts self placed as ruler and savior of our life.

Rom 7:21-25: So I find it to be a law that when I want to do right, evil lies close at hand. For I delight in the law of God, in my inner being, but I see in my members another law waging war against the law of my mind and making me captive to the law of sin that dwells in my members. Wretched man that I am! Who will deliver me from this body of death? Thanks be to God through Jesus Christ our Lord! So then, I myself serve the law of God with my mind, but with my flesh I serve the law of sin.

Who loves you enough to tell you you're walking against Christ?

2.3.4 Corrupted Desires

2.3.4.1 Lust (more than just sexual) James 4:1-2.

Look over list of lusts

Source of quarrels: Lusts

2.3.4.2 Fear - an expression of worship (The thing we fear have power over us)

Another expression of pride and idolatry ruling our hearts is unholy fear. Fear is always an expression of worship and deep reverence. This is one reason the Scripture calls us to fear God alone. Only God deserves our worship and deep reverence. Yet we enter the world fearing almost everyone and everything besides Him. p53

Look over list of fears

Lust & Fear go hand in hand: longings and fear of missing out

2.3.4.3 Futile attempts to reconcile ourselves to God

Inability to reconcile ourselves to God → Adam and Eve attempted to cover w/ Skins → Hiding From God → Blaming one another

2.3.5 REDEMPTION

Old testament provided temporary deliverance through the shedding of blood.

Rom 3:21-22 ²¹ But now the righteousness of God has been manifested apart from the law, although the Law and the Prophets bear witness to it— ²² the righteousness of God through faith in Jesus Christ for all who believe. For there is no distinction:

Salvation is more than freedom from sin and death → New peaceful relation w/ God

II Cor 5:14-15: ¹⁴ For the love of Christ controls us, because we have concluded this: that one has died for all, therefore all have died; ¹⁵ and he died for all, that those who live might no longer live for themselves but for him who for their sake died and was raised.

2.3.6 NEW PERSON

The reality of eternal life, when we consider it truthfully and often enough, controls the way that we live in this present life.

2.3.7 Questions:

What kind of rhythms do you have set in your lives for regular accountability - encouragement in a life of repentance and obedience?

Page 58 - Question #7 “What do you tend to run after for comfort, refuge, or deliverance? Do you run to sports, food, career, isolation, or something else?”

2.4 Chapter 4

Do you carry a zeal for the eternal purposes of God?

Purpose of Marriage

Gen 2:18-25: ¹⁸ Then the Lord God said, “It is not good that the man should be alone; I will make him a helper fit for him.” ¹⁹ Now out of the ground the Lord God had formed every beast of the field and every bird of the heavens and brought them to the man to see what he would call them. And whatever the man called every living creature, that was its name. ²⁰ The man gave names to all livestock and to the birds of the heavens and to every beast of the field. But for Adam there was not found a helper fit for him. ²¹ So the Lord God caused a deep sleep to fall upon the man, and while he slept took one of his ribs and closed up its place with flesh. ²² And the rib that the Lord God had taken from the man he made into a woman and brought her to the man. ²³ Then the man said,

“This at last is bone of my bones and flesh of my flesh;
she shall be called Woman, because she was taken out of Man.”

²⁴ Therefore a man shall leave his father and his mother and hold fast to his wife, and they shall become one flesh. ²⁵ And the man and his wife were both naked and were not ashamed.

Marriage doesn't belong to the couple, but belongs to God

No helper suitable for him

For this reason: Leave + cleave

Created to know, enjoy, worship God

Not good to be alone - God was part of a family

Adam had one to love/serve

AND There was no helper suitable for him

Everything created exists to glorify God

Alone, Adam couldn't display the image of God

Marriage is a gift from God (to be stewarded) for his purposes. => God is with us, for us, and committed to our marriages

Marriage is a covenant which pictures, embodies, and points to the eternal covenant between Christ and the church.

Marriage exists as a means of multiplying

Marriage exists to exhort the next generation

But spiritual multiplication is primary ->

Covenant

Go and make disciples

2.4.1 Questions:

Have you learned anything about yourselves and each other and your relationship since the last time we met?

Page 73 - Questions #1-2 Explain what "Let no man separate" means to you

What difficulties do you foresee in leaving your original family in order to be joined to your husband or wife? Share ways in which you could be too attached to or dependent upon your father, mother, or siblings - whether this involves their approval, respect, money, or advice

Page 77 - Questions #5-6 Share your desires for having children or not having children Share your fears about having children

2.5 Chapter 5 Covenant

"Christian marriage should be distinguished from other kinds of marriage not by the absence

Noah ~ Rainbow was a sign

Abraham~ Circumcision

Law as book of the covenant Ex 24:7

New covenant foretold

Jer 31:33-34 ³³ For this is the covenant that I will make with the house of Israel after those days, declares the Lord: I will put my law within them, and I will write it on their hearts. And I will be their God, and they shall be my people. ³⁴ And no longer shall each one teach his neighbor and each his brother, saying, 'Know the Lord,' for they shall all know me, from the least of them to the greatest, declares the Lord. For I will forgive their iniquity, and I will remember their sin no more."

2.5.1 COVENANT

Noahic Covenant

Abrahamic Covenant

2.5.2 New Covenant

For this reason Christ is the mediator of a new covenant, that those who are called may receive the promised eternal inheritance—now that he has died as a ransom to set them free from the sins committed under the first covenant. - Heb 9:15 NIV

2.5.3 Marriage Covenants

The LORD has been a witness between you and the wife of your youth, against whom you have dealt treacherously, though she is your companion and your wife by covenant" (Mal. 2:14).

Covenant-keeping by Grace

Problem w/ living under the law and judging our spouse under the law

Mt 11:29-30 ²⁹ Take my yoke upon you, and learn from me, for I am gentle and lowly in heart, and you will find rest for your souls. ³⁰ For my yoke is easy, and my burden is light.

Col 3:12-13: ¹² Put on then, as God's chosen ones, holy and beloved, compassionate hearts, kindness, humility, meekness, and patience, ¹³ bearing with one another and, if one has a complaint against another, forgiving each other; as the Lord has forgiven you, so you also must forgive.

As we grasp God's compassion for us -> We have compassion for others

Col 3:14 ¹⁶ Let the word of Christ dwell in you richly, teaching and admonishing one another in all wisdom, singing psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, with thankfulness in your hearts to God.

Divorce breaks the covenant

We Enjoy and Keep Covenant with One Another by Grace

We mature together and face sin together in his Grace

In Colossians 3:14–16, Paul keeps unpacking the implications of being recipients of the grace of God through Jesus Christ. Beyond all these things put on love, which is the perfect bond of unity. Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, to which indeed you were called in one body; and be thankful. Let the word of Christ richly dwell within you, with all wisdom teaching and admonishing one another with psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing with thankfulness in your hearts to God.

2.5.4 Divorce Breaks the Covenant

II Cor 5:18 : ¹⁸ All this is from God, who through Christ reconciled us to himself and gave us the ministry of reconciliation; ¹⁹ that is, in Christ God was reconciling^[d] the world to himself, not counting their trespasses against them, and entrusting to us the message of reconciliation. ²⁰ Therefore, we are ambassadors for Christ, God making his appeal through us. We implore you on behalf of Christ, be reconciled to God. ²¹ For our sake he made him to be sin who knew no sin, so that in him we might become the righteousness of God.

2.5.5 Grace and Law in Marriage

Page 95: Christian marriage is different not by absence of sin but by redeeming and reconciling Grace

2.6 Questions

I usually start this meeting with a talk on the practice of identifying evidences of grace in one another. The practice of being on the lookout for places where you see the Spirit of God doing good work in one another and making that a regular practice/culture in marriage. I then ask them to practice - tell me one place you see in your fiancé that the Lord is clearly at work - actually - talk to each other. Then I ask them to identify one evidence of grace in their relationship.

How is a covenantal view of marriage different from a contractual view of marriage (or pg 84, Q1)?

How have you spoken the truth in love to others? In what ways do you either run over people in criticisms and judgement or say nothing in order to avoid conflict and keep others pleased with you.

Page 95Quote

2.6.1 Jesus' View of Divorce

Matt 5:19-29: ³ And Pharisees came up to him and tested him by asking, "Is it lawful to divorce one's wife for any cause?" ⁴ He answered, "Have you not read that he who created them from the beginning made them male and female, ⁵ and said, 'Therefore a man shall leave his father and his mother and hold fast to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh'? ⁶ So they are no longer two but one flesh. What therefore God has joined together, let not man separate."⁷ They said to him, "Why then did Moses command one to give a certificate of divorce and to send her away?" ⁸ He said to them, "Because of your hardness of heart Moses allowed you to divorce your wives, but from the beginning it was not so. ⁹ And I say to you: whoever divorces his wife, except for sexual immorality, and marries another, commits adultery."^[a]

¹⁰ The disciples said to him, "If such is the case of a man with his wife, it is better not to marry." ¹¹ But he said to them, "Not everyone can receive this saying, but only those to whom it is given. ¹² For there are eunuchs who have been so from birth, and there are eunuchs who have been made eunuchs by men, and there are eunuchs who have made themselves eunuchs for the sake of the kingdom of heaven. Let the one who is able to receive this receive it."

2.6.2 Why does God hate divorce?

But not one has done so who has a remnant of the Spirit. And what did that one do while he was seeking a godly offspring? Take heed then to your spirit, and let no

one deal treacherously against the wife of your youth. "For I hate divorce," says the LORD, the God of Israel, "and him who covers his garment with wrong," says the LORD of hosts. "So take heed to your spirit, that you do not deal treacherously." (Mal. 2:15-16)

2.6.2.1 Exception for Spouse who desires to leave

Are you free to marry?

8. Have you or your fiancé been divorced in the past? If so, please briefly explain the circumstances.
9. 9. According to God's Word, are you and your fiancé free to marry each other? If you or your fiancé have been divorced, then please read the following passages:

Gen 2:23-24

Matthew 19:1-10

Mark 10:1-12

1 Cor 7:10-16

10. If your previous spouse sinfully divorced you, to what degree does resentment, anger, and guilt linger from your previous marriage and divorce?

2.7 Chapter 6 - Becoming a Husband

To the woman he said, "I will make your pains in childbearing very severe; with painful labor you will give birth to children. Your desire will be for your husband, and he will rule over you." To Adam he said, "Because you listened to your wife and ate fruit from the tree about which I commanded you, 'You must not eat from it,' "Cursed is the ground because of you; through painful toil you will eat food from it all the days of your life. It will produce thorns and thistles for you, and you will eat the plants of the field. By the sweat of your brow you will eat your food until you return to the ground, since from it you were taken; for dust you are and to dust you will return." Genesis 3

	Created	Cursed	Redeemed
Woman	Helper Suitable	Desire husband's role	Submitted
Man	Exercise Dominion	Lord it over wife	Self-sacrifice
Marriage	Be Fruitful and Multiply		Demonstrate Christ+Church

Preface - Be filled with the Spirit: Leadership and Submission won't work without the Spirit

Eph 5:18-21: And do not get drunk with wine, for that is dissipation, but be filled with the Spirit, speaking to one another in psalms and hymns and spiritual songs, singing and making melody with your heart to the LORD; always giving thanks for all things in the name of our LORD Jesus Christ to God, even the Father; and be subject to one another in the fear of Christ.

Filled with the Spirit

- New creation
- Trusting/Honoring Good
- Strengthened in his power
- Not ruled by worldly desire

Results of being Filled

- Speaking in psalms
- Singing/making melody
- Giving thanks
- Being subject to one another

Eph 5:25-33 Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church and gave himself up for her, so that He might sanctify her, having cleansed her by the washing of water with the word, that He might present to Himself the church in all her glory, having no spot or wrinkle or any such thing; but that she would be holy and blameless. So husbands ought also to love their own wives as their own bodies. He who loves his own wife loves himself; for no one ever hated his own flesh, but nourishes and cherishes it, just as Christ also does the church, because we are members of His body. For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and shall be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh. This mystery is great; but I am speaking with reference to Christ and the church. Nevertheless, each individual among you also is to love his own wife even as himself, and the wife must see to it that she respects her husband.

2.7.0.1 #1 Husband: Joyful sacrifice for the eternal well-being of his wife

John 10:11 I am the Good Shepherd (who lays down his life)

Heb 12:2 For the joy set before Him endured the cross, despising the shame

Col 3:19 Husbands love your wives and do not be embittered against them

- Joyful sacrifice
- Speaking truth in love
- Praying for Wife
- Confront wife's sinfulness in a gracious way

2.7.0.2 As his own body ...nourish and cherish...

(training for sports analogy)

2.7.0.3 #2 With understanding and showing honor

Husbands, in the same way be considerate as you live with your wives, and treat them with respect as the weaker partner and as heirs with you of the gracious gift of life, so that nothing will hinder your prayers. [1Pe 3:7 NIV]

Weaker vessel:

- Submission places XX in a vulnerable position (weakness)
- XX role is different/distinct (suitable helper): Thoughts and reactions will be different
- Physical delicacy
- Susceptibility to error

Fellow heirs - recognize the ways in which God speaks to and through your spouse (spiritual antennae)

So when a husband is called to love his wife as Christ loved the church, he is called to joyfully sacrifice himself for the eternal welfare of his bride. This sacrifice is an attempt to lead his bride toward the Father for her good and the Father's glory. This service leads him to pray for sanctification and growth in his bride. A husband who loves his bride this way seeks to help her glorify and enjoy her eternal husband, Jesus Christ. A husband who is learning to love his wife just as Christ also loved the church is also learning to speak the truth in love to his wife. He learns to pay careful attention to her words and to receive her thoughts with thanksgiving. He strives to be tender and compassionate. He learns to pray with his wife and for his wife. He reads the Scripture with her and listens to her views about the Word of God. He longs to give

himself sexually and exercises patience when she declines to give her body in return. He prays to serve his bride without expecting service in return. He initiates conversation. He confesses sin genuinely. He forgives her and refuses to hold grudges. A husband who is learning to love his wife just as Christ also loved the church is also learning to confront his wife's sinfulness in a gracious way. He is learning not to avoid painful interactions or to pretend things are okay in marriage when they are not. If his wife thinks they need help in their marriage, he humbles himself and seeks the aid of wise friends or pastors. He leads his marriage toward Christ and the body of Christ. He leads it into regular worship and service in the church. He is learning to lead it in wise and generous use of money. He works hard at his job without living for his career. He works faithfully at his job, whether it pays well or not, simply because he loves God and his wife. He is learning not to LORD authority over his wife but to serve and encourage her in Christ. pp108-109

2.7.1 Leaving Parents

For this reason a man shall leave his father and mother and be joined to his wife, and the two shall become one flesh. . . . So they are no longer two, but one flesh. What therefore God has joined together, let no man separate. (Matt. 19:5–6)

The instruction for a son to honor his father and mother also changes from a call to obey and

Pg 105 - Question #2 If there are things that he wants to talk about - I will engage. But for the most part I spend this time talking about what it means to be a biblical man / husband. God given responsibility to lead, serve, and protect. What is your view of biblical headship & submission?

2.8 Chapter 7 - Becoming a Wife

Husband	Wife
Joyful assumption of sacrifice for the eternal good of his spouse for the glory of God => Submission to Christ	Joyful honoring of husband's will and position for the eternal fruitfulness of her husband for the glory of God => Submission to Husband

2.8.0.1 Submission started in the Godhead

Genesis: I will make a suitable helper

Temporal, visible, living picture of the eternal, invisible, living reality of Christ and His church

Wife- display attitudes, affections, activities that Christ should have towards the church

Eph 5- Be filled with the Spirit

We work out our salvation

Phil 2:12-13

It is God who is at work in you

Power for obeying comes from God

John 15:5 I am the vine

Submission + Headship starts in the Godhead

Wives, be subject to your own husbands, as to the LORD. For the husband is the head of the wife, as Christ also is the head of the church, He Himself being the Savior of the body. But as the church is subject to Christ, so also the wives ought to be to their husbands in everything. (Eph. 5:22–24)

God is the head of Christ I Cor 15:28

...As to the Lord

...In everything - except Sin- Christ would not lead the church into sin...

Submission to Christ overrules submission to husband

.. As is fitting in the Lord = fitting to a Christian Woman

Wives, in the same way submit yourselves to your own husbands so that, if any of them do not believe the word, they may be won over without words by the behavior of their wives, when they see the purity and reverence of your lives. Your beauty should not come from outward adornment, such as elaborate hairstyles and the wearing of gold jewelry or fine clothes. Rather, it should be that of your inner self, the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit, which is of great worth in God's sight. For this is the way the holy women of the past who put their hope in God used to adorn themselves. They submitted themselves to their own husbands, like Sarah, who obeyed Abraham and called him her lord. You are her daughters if you do what is right and do not give way to fear. [1Pe 3:1-6 NIV]

Woman's source of hope and protection:

hope in God I Peter 3:5

A wife who is learning to be subject to her husband “as to the LORD” is learning to speak to her husband in kind and respectful ways. She seeks to fulfill his desires for their household without begrudging them or resenting what they cost. She is learning to give herself more freely in sexual union. She appreciates the opportunity to serve him. She is praying to be “a suitable helper” (see Gen. 2:18), in every sense of the phrase. The wife who is learning to honor her husband “as to the LORD” longs to speak the truth in love to her husband. She refuses to nag and criticize him. She shares concerns with her husband but tries not to demand or threaten. When he sins against her, she gently confronts him for his own good and the pleasure of Christ. If he responds in pride and rejects all her petitions, then she carefully, courageously, and prayerfully seeks help from a trusted friend or from others in the body of Christ. She prays for reconciliation with her husband, not retribution. When she is afraid, she prays and runs to God for strength, faith, and wisdom. When life seems to be crumbling, she runs to Christ first, then to her husband. She trusts the Holy Spirit with the sanctification of her husband. The wife who loves her husband does not expect him to provide her sense of value and purpose in life. She looks to God to be her God and Savior. She believes herself to be “chosen of God, holy and beloved” (Col. 3:12), and longs to walk securely in the promises of God. She is learning to repent often and to seek God's forgiveness. She even repents before her earthly husband and seeks his forgiveness. If she understands and walks in the Scripture with more maturity than her husband, then she also walks humbly before God and refuses to view her husband in a condescending way. She wants to help her husband love God according to God's sense of time and perspective. Increasingly she views her place in marriage as a privilege and gift from God, not as a chore and certainly not as a punishment. She is learning to keep her home well—to be faithful in every duty that the LORD assigns. A wife who loves her husband is learning to view her every attitude, thought, and action toward her husband as an expression of her love for Jesus Christ. (pp129-130)

2.8.0.2 Leaving and Cleaving

Gen 2:24 Men are instructed to leave their parents, but not women: (culturally) assumed that a woman leaves her Family because and through marriage. Grooms need to leave and are not given away'

Is this man someone you can entrust yourself?

Questions:

- Family of origin- How did you see your parents interacting in leading/following?
- Expectations about teamwork
- How did your accepting Christ change your expectations?

- How has the chapter challenged or encouraged your expectations?
- What do you anticipate will be difficult?

2.9 Chapter 8 - Conflict

Source of all conflict

James 4:1-4: What causes quarrels and what causes fights among you? Is it not this, that your passions are at war within you? ² You desire and do not have, so you murder. You covet and cannot obtain, so you fight and quarrel. You do not have, because you do not ask. ³ You ask and do not receive, because you ask wrongly, to spend it on your passions.⁴ You adulterous people! Do you not know that friendship with the world is enmity with God? Therefore whoever wishes to be a friend of the world makes himself an enemy of God.

Selfish desires - fear of failure, pain, disapproval

Idolatry - Desires that lead us to sin to achieve or preserve them, or sin in attitude or action when our efforts to achieve or preserve them fail. These can be good desires which outweigh our desire for God's glory and eternal purposes.

2.9.1 Expressions of conflict in Marriage

1. Corrupt Words.

The good man out of the good treasure of his heart brings forth what is good; and the evil man out of the evil treasure brings forth what is evil; for his mouth speaks from that which fills his heart Luke 6:45

2. Rejection of correction

3. Acting as Two - Acting w/o regard for spouse

4. Trusting in our own eyes (*vs* God's word)

- Cain
- Jonah

We can pray for good things from God but with selfish/evil motives.

Questions:

1. Anything you have encountered recently that puts into practice the material we have covered so far?

2. What sorts of fears and desires represent the greatest temptation for you?
3. What have you learned from observing how your families handled conflict growing up?
4. What have you learned from the conflicts you have had so far? What you learn about yourself? your fiancé? and about how to constructively handle conflict?

I'm generally after a cohesive understanding of how each saw conflict handled in their family of origin and how they've tended to handle conflict as a couple thus far. This almost always becomes a conversation about communication.

When conflict enters - is your fiancé the one you are in conflict with or are you two united to deal with the conflict?

What does it look like to be "on the same team" against a particular conflict?

Put into the practice - regularly asking one another - "If you knew I wouldn't get defensive or angry - what is one thing you think I could do to be a better husband / wife to you?"

2.10 Chapter 9

Humble yourself, and he will exalt you

Marriage conflict begins with our war with God

2 Peter 1:3-4 His divine power has granted to us all things that pertain to life and godliness, through the knowledge of him who called us to ^[c] his own glory and excellence, ^[d] ⁴ by which he has granted to us his precious and very great promises, so that through them you may become partakers of the divine nature, having escaped from the corruption that is in the world because of sinful desire.

cf Unforgiving servant

Need hearts that love God

Ask yourself: What does my heart love so strongly that I am willing to fight for it?

Eager for forgiveness:

- w/o repentance, we can cover a transgression OR confront
- w/repentance (and confession)-> cancel and bring restoration

Question: When do you cover a transgression and when do you confront?

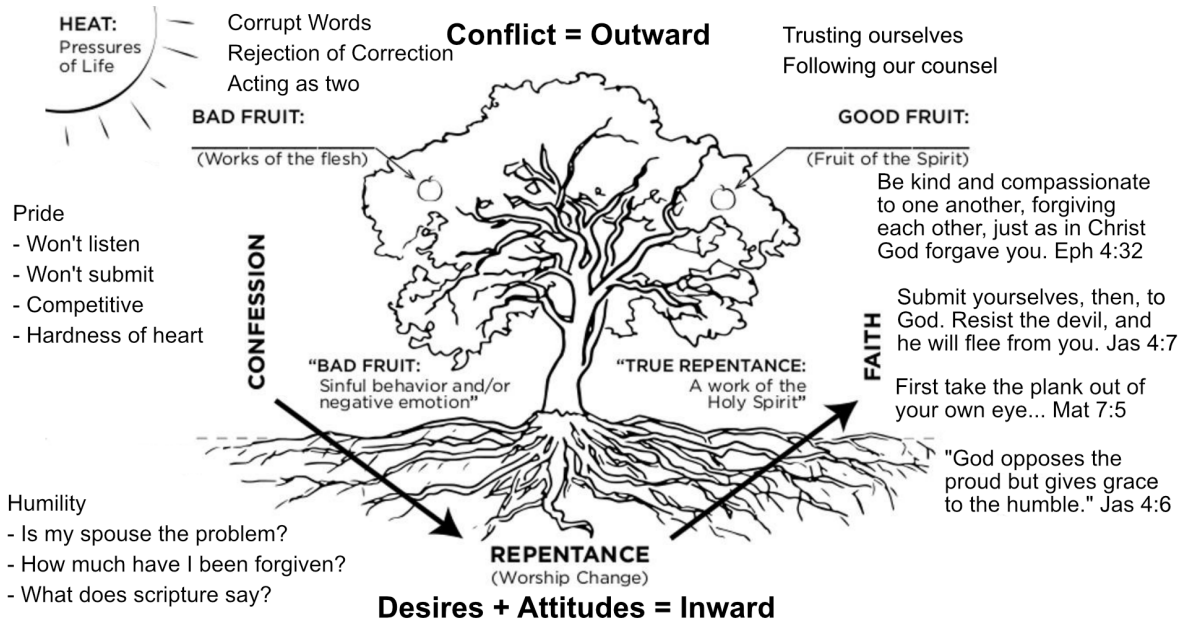
Trusting the Lord: A trustworthy spouse is a gift, but we are called to trust God

Hands that serve cheerfully

whoever wishes to be great among you shall be your servant

Lips that edify vs Speaks rashly like a sword.

It's a heart issue and not a communication issue



Problem: Relationship with the Lord - What controls us? = Desires that battle within you James 4:11

Figure 2.1: Trees of the Heart

[Full Screen](#)

[PDF](#)

Can you unpack a recent conflict you feel comfortable sharing and see how what you have learned in the book?

2.11 Chapter 10 Becoming One Flesh

Consumation = completion of the covenant

Opportunity to celebrate our union with the Lord by serving and enjoying union with our spouse.

Using relationship between Jesus and the church helps us to see sexual perversion in context

Sexual perversion = false worship

Render the Affection Due = Fulfill his duty to their spouse...

Obstacles-

- Premarital sexual Immorality
 - Importance of confession/repentance
 - Every other sin a man commits is outside the body, but the immoral man sins against his own body
- Pornography
 - Job. I will make a covenant / my eyes.
 - Mt 5:28 Whoever looks upon a person (God is interested in pure hearts)
 - Prov 7:22-23
 - Have you had prior exposure? If so, how do you think it will affect your marriage. if not, have you thought about safeguards you can put in place?
- Past abuse

2.12 Chapter 11 Financial Stewardship

For where your treasure is, there will your heart be also (Matt 6:21)

Joseph as archtypical steward - maintain and cultivate property, but don't own it.

Overseer... Is God's steward Titus 1:7

Budgets are tools

Underlying key: Is Christ ruling in your heart? "The foxes that would wreak havoc in the vineyard of your marriage come in the form of pride, selfishness, fear, control, and a host of other heart conditions". Fighting over money arises from hearts that use money based upon sinful cravings and fears.

Honoring Christ in our stewardship

2.12.1 Diligent work

For you yourselves know how you ought to follow our example. We were not idle when we were with you, nor did we eat anyone's food without paying for it. On the contrary, we worked night and day, laboring and toiling so that we would not be a burden to any of you. We did this, not because we do not have the right to such help, but in order to offer ourselves as a model for you to imitate. For even when we were with you, we gave you this rule: "The one who is unwilling to work shall not eat." 2 Thess 3:7-10 NIV

In what ways are you tempted to overwork (or underwork)?

2.12.2 Faithful Giving

2.12.3 Wise Preparation for the Future

Proverbs: Consider the Ant

Stewards of treasure, time, talent

Questions:

Who is the spender? Who is the saver?

What does it look like for you two to prioritize kingdom values in your financial stewardship as a married couple?

What do your sabbath practices look like?

How do your schedules differ?

What is your current work/life balance?

How does job stress affect you? affect your relationship?

Do either of you need time alone during the week to recharge?

What are your plans for time together? (3min/day, 3 hours/week, 3 days/year)

Areas of struggle or opportunities for growth? Do you need help with budgeting or other financial preparations?

2.13 Chapter 12 Expectations

1. What did you learn from the lists?
2. Anything you want to discuss?

Good desires vs sinful desires (*why* do we want something?) (reprise from chapter 8)

2.13.1 Two kingdoms in conflict (p 223)

- Submission to the Kingdom of God
- Kingdom of self

We are all just like Ethan. There is a war being waged in our hearts. Two kingdoms and wills are clashing. Paul was aware of this war within himself: “I find then the principle that evil is present in me, the one who wants to do good” (Rom. 7:21). He alerts us to this war in Galatians 5:17:

For the flesh desires what is contrary to the Spirit, and the Spirit what is contrary to the flesh. They are in conflict with each other, so that you are not to do whatever you want. But if you are led by the Spirit, you are not under the law. The acts of the flesh are obvious: sexual immorality, impurity and debauchery; idolatry and witchcraft; hatred, discord, jealousy, fits of rage, selfish ambition, dissensions, factions and envy; drunkenness, orgies, and the like. I warn you, as I did before, that those who live like this will not inherit the kingdom of God. But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, forbearance, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness and self-control. Against such things there is no law. Those who belong to Christ Jesus have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires. Since we live by the Spirit, let us keep in step with the Spirit. - Gal 5:17-25

The battle is very real. It is costly, and it can take many forms:

- God’s glory versus my glory,
- God’s kingdom versus my kingdom, hope set on Him versus hope set on the world,
- treasure in heaven versus treasure on earth.

*No matter what form it takes, this war will drastically impact our desires and, therefore, our expectations for marriage. The **real test of your heart will come when you don’t get what you want**. It will come when your spouse offends you. It will come when your mate fails to meet your expectations. After all, marriage will disappoint you. Of this you can be certain. At some point in the days ahead, your spouse will cut you off on the marriage highway. It will probably happen on a regular basis. And at those moments, the real desire of your heart will be exposed. When your spouse dishonors you, refuses sexual intimacy, shuts you out emotionally,*

blows the budget, or confronts sin in your life, whatever rules your heart will become more evident than ever before.

2.13.2 Disappointment

Examine both our expectations AND our response when our expectations are not met

Please feel free to have expectations. Just make sure they are the right ones and that they are submitted to the right Person!

- Expect yourself to sacrifice.
- Expect God to be faithful.
- Expect Him to ask you to forgive your mate as He has forgiven you.
- Expect moments of joy at the most unlikely times.
- Expect disappointment in marriage and God's grace to love your spouse the way that He loves you.
- Expect to be amazed when your mate loves you far more than you actually deserve.
- Expect your sin to create a lot of trouble, and expect to repent often.
- Expect your enjoyment of God and of your mate to grow as you grow closer to Him.

Hope (another word for expectations) - Where is our hope?

And hope does not put us to shame, because God's love has been poured out into our hearts through the Holy Spirit, who has been given to us. - Rom 5:5

Plan on God being near to you and being for your marriage. He promises to give you His Spirit's power for the road ahead. We should expect and know that He will be faithful. p 226

I say all this as your wedding approaches so that you will see and enjoy marriage for what God intends it to be, without fixing your hope on it. Love your God-given mate. Enjoy your God-given mate. Serve, take pleasure in, and receive blessings from your beloved spouse. Just make sure not to worship your mate, demand from your spouse what only Christ can supply, or seek marriage as an end to itself. Relish marriage w2'765re4wq890. m,. ÷ 2as a beautiful picture. Cherish it as a glorious display. Only remember whom it displays and who makes the picture so beautiful. May the LORD make your days of marriage full and rich in Him! p229

3 Drew Tucker Key Questions:

3.0.1 Chapter 1:

- I start by having each person share their personal testimony.
- How would you describe your present relationship with the Lord (spiritual disciplines, intimacy etc.)?
- What would be one area of spiritual growth that you believe you need help in?
- Tell me the story of you two meeting, courting, engagement.
- What did you learn about marriage from your family of origin that you'd like to emulate?
- What would you like to do differently?
- Commitment to purity (victories, struggles)?
- Have you talked about past sexual sin, abuse, involvement?

Answers given generally set the pace for where the conversation goes next.

3.0.2 Chapter 2:

Page 47 - Question #4 “What do you think it means to seek Christ and his Kingdom in your marriage?”

3.0.3 Chapter 3:

What kind of rhythms do you have set in your lives for regular accountability - encouragement in a life of repentance and obedience?

Page 58 - Question #7 “What do you tend to run after for comfort, refuge, or deliverance? Do you run to sports, food, career, isolation, or something else?”

3.0.4 Chapter 4:

Page 73 - Questions #1-2 Explain what “Let no man separate” means to you

What difficulties do you foresee in leaving your original family in order to be joined to your husband or wife? Share ways in which you could be too attached to or dependent upon your father, mother, or siblings - whether this involves their approval, respect, money, or advice

Page 77 - Questions #5-6 Share your desires for having children or not having children Share your fears about having children

3.0.5 Chapter 5:

I usually start this meeting with a talk on the practice of identifying evidences of grace in one another. The practice of being on the lookout for places where you see the Spirit of God doing good work in one another and making that a regular practice/culture in marriage. I then ask them to practice - tell me one place you see in your fiancé that the Lord is clearly at work - actually - talk to each other. Then I ask them to identify one evidence of grace in their relationship.

How is a covenantal view of marriage different from a contractual view of marriage (or pg 84, Q1)?

Explain your perspective on divorce. Is it an option as you go into marriage? Usually looking for solid understanding of covenant and generally want to hear from a couple that divorce is a last resort.

3.0.6 Chapter 6:

- Pg 105 - Question #2 If there are things that he wants to talk about - I will engage. But for the most part I spend this time talking about what it means to be a biblical man / husband. God given responsibility to lead, serve, and protect. What is your view of biblical headship & submission?

3.0.7 Chapter 7:

- What is your view of biblical headship & submission?
- Pg 130 - Q4
- Pg 131 - Q5
- Pg 137 - Q8

3.0.8 Chapters 8-9:

I probably lean less heavily on book questions for these chapters. I'm generally after a cohesive understanding of how each saw conflict handled in their family of origin and how they've tended to handle conflict as a couple thus far. This almost always becomes a conversation about communication. When conflict enters - is your fiancé the one you are in conflict with or are you two united to deal with the conflict? What does it look like to be "on the same team" against a particular conflict? Put into the practice - regularly asking one another - "If you knew I wouldn't get defensive or angry - what is one thing you think I could do to be a better husband / wife to you?"

3.0.9 Chapter 10:

How did your conversation about this chapter prior to our meeting go? Are there specific ways I can serve you two as y'all prepare for sexual intimacy?

3.0.10 Chapter 11:

Who is the spender? Who is the saver? What does it look like for you two to prioritize kingdom values in your financial stewardship as a married couple? What is your current work/life balance? Areas of struggle or opportunities for growth? Do you need help with budgeting or other financial preparations?

3.0.11 Chapter 12:

No specific questions I lean on here. This usually winds up being more of a discussion of expectations based on the accumulated information I have from meeting with the couple over time.

4 Premarital Coaching

4.0.1 Questions July 2025

Resources: Catching Foxes

Scope: How many couples are married in the church each year? Salos can manage 3 couples/year

Training a team

- Need 1 or 2 other couples to help with counseling as needs increase
- Read the Catching Foxes book
- Training sessions with Drew and Jessie (and Jonathan and Kelly)

“Red Flags” - Need a plan for these scenarios:

- Chastity - Couple is living together/sleeping together
- Pornography
- History of sexual abuse

Which scenarios are ones in which a pastor would want to be notified/involved during the premarital counseling course (eg pornography addiction)

Pornography When/How do we inquire? How do we triage how serious a pornography problem is? Inadvertent exposure Occasional Use Intensive use Compulsive use (addiction) What resources do we have to help men (and women) find victory? Who needs professional counseling for pornography? Is there a role for providing help for the whole congregation in battling pornography? (eg bulk purchase of covenant eyes software)

Finances/Budgeting

Communications

Conflict resolution

Family planning (in the broadest context)

Date Nights Newlywed counseling

- What should we plan to offer for counseling after the wedding?

4.0.1.1 Meeting with Drew/Jonathan August 2025

Can complete in 4-6-8 sessions

1. Chapter 1
2. Chapter 2 and 3
3. Chapter 4 and 5
4. Chapter 6 and 7
5. Chapter 8 and 9
6. Chapter 10 (meet separately)
7. Chapter 11 and 12 (optional - budgeting)

Part II

BEMA

5 Concepts

6 Concepts

6.1 Tzedakah - Righteousness

7 Bible Study Tools

API.bible. scripture.api.bible

8 Pre-Assyrian Prophets

Prophetic Themes

- Idolatry (Source A)
- Injustice (Source B)
- Hope in the midst of judgement

8.1 Amos - Plumbline (and ripe fruit)

Prophet to Israel

8.2 Hosea - Prostitute

Prophet to Israel

8.3 Micah - Judge {BEMA50}

Prophet to Judah

God is looking for tzedekah, but instead finds Tze'ekah

Hope: Surely I will gather you, Jacob, I will bring together the remnant of Israel. I will bring them together like sheep in a pen, like a flock in its pasture. The place will throng with people. The one who breaks open the way will go up before them. They will break through the gate and go out. Their king will pass before them, the Lord at their head.

Hezekiah is a King of Judah who repents (and God spares Judah)

8.4 1 Isaiah - Vineyard {BEMA51}

8.5 Jonah - Potential {BEMA52}

8.6 Nahum - Diyn {BEMA53}

Diyn - retributive justice (against Ninevah)

vs mishpat = restorative justice

8.7 Zephaniah - T'shuvah (return) {BEMA54}

Prophecizes against the priests who set up a Molech sacrificial center (in Valley of Hinnon)

8.8 2 Isaiah - Woe {BEMA55}

Isaiah 13-39

8.8.1 Taunt against the King of Babylon

12 “How you are fallen from heaven, O Day Star, son of Dawn! How you are cut down to the ground, you who laid the nations low! 13 You said in your heart, ‘I will ascend to heaven; above the stars of God I will set my throne on high; I will sit on the mount of assembly in the far reaches of the north;[c] 14 I will ascend above the heights of the clouds; I will make myself like the Most High.’ 15 But you are brought down to Sheol, to the far reaches of the pit. 16 Those who see you will stare at you and ponder over you: ‘Is this the man who made the earth tremble, who shook kingdoms, 17 who made the world like a desert and overthrew its cities, who did not let his prisoners go home?’ 18 All the kings of the nations lie in glory, each in his own tomb;[d] 19 but you are cast out, away from your grave, like a loathed branch, clothed with the slain, those pierced by the sword, who go down to the stones of the pit, like a dead body trampled underfoot. 20 You will not be joined with them in burial, because you have destroyed your land, you have slain your people.

This passage has been applied to Satan, but context (before and after) states it relates to the King of Babylon

cf Ezekiah 28

8.9 Isaiah 36

Format changes from poetry back to prose (like Kings)

8.10 Jeremiah - Weeping {BEMA56}

Babylonian prophet

8.10.1 Valley of Slaughter 7:30

Gehenna used 12 times in NT, 11 by Jesus. Derived from Geehenom = Valley of Hinnom. Actual valley outside Jerusalem. Also known as Topheth

7:30 “For the sons of Judah have done evil in my sight, declares the Lord. They have set their detestable things in the house that is called by my name, to defile it. 31 And they have built the high places of Topheth, which is in the Valley of the Son of Hinnom, to burn their sons and their daughters in the fire, which I did not command, nor did it come into my mind. 32 Therefore, behold, the days are coming, declares the Lord, when it will no more be called Topheth, or the Valley of the Son of Hinnom, but the Valley of Slaughter; for they will bury in Topheth, because there is no room elsewhere. 33 And the dead bodies of this people will be food for the birds of the air, and for the beasts of the earth, and none will frighten them away. 34 And I will silence in the cities of Judah and in the streets of Jerusalem the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, for the land shall become a waste.

8 “At that time, declares the Lord, the bones of the kings of Judah, the bones of its officials, the bones of the priests, the bones of the prophets, and the bones of the inhabitants of Jerusalem shall be brought out of their tombs. ² And they shall be spread before the sun and the moon and all the host of heaven, which they have loved and served, which they have gone after, and which they have sought and worshiped. And they shall not be gathered or buried. They shall be as dung on the surface of the ground. ³ Death shall be preferred to life by all the remnant that remains of this evil family in all the places where I have driven them, declares the Lord of hosts.

19 Thus says the Lord, “Go, buy a potter’s earthenware flask, and take some of the elders of the people and some of the elders of the priests, ² and go out to the Valley of the Son of Hinnom at the entry of the Potsherd Gate, and proclaim there the words that I tell you. ³ You shall say, ‘Hear the word of the Lord, O kings of Judah and inhabitants of Jerusalem. Thus says the Lord of hosts, the God of Israel: Behold, I am bringing such disaster upon this place that the ears of everyone who hears of it will tingle. ⁴ Because the people have forsaken me and have profaned this

place by making offerings in it to other gods whom neither they nor their fathers nor the kings of Judah have known; and because they have filled this place with the blood of innocents,⁵ and have built the high places of Baal to burn their sons in the fire as burnt offerings to Baal, which I did not command or decree, nor did it come into my mind—⁶ therefore, behold, days are coming, declares the Lord, when this place shall no more be called **Topheth**, or the Valley of the Son of Hinnom, but the Valley of Slaughter.⁷ And in this place I will make void the plans of Judah and Jerusalem, and will cause their people to fall by the sword before their enemies, and by the hand of those who seek their life. I will give their dead bodies for food to the birds of the air and to the beasts of the earth.⁸ And I will make this city a horror, a thing to be hissed at. Everyone who passes by it will be horrified and will hiss because of all its wounds.⁹ And I will make them eat the flesh of their sons and their daughters, and everyone shall eat the flesh of his neighbor in the siege and in the distress, with which their enemies and those who seek their life afflict them.’

8.10.2 70 Years of Babylonian Captivity

25 The word that came to Jeremiah concerning all the people of Judah, in the fourth year of Jehoiakim the son of Josiah, king of Judah (that was the first year of Nebuchadnezzar king of Babylon),² which Jeremiah the prophet spoke to all the people of Judah and all the inhabitants of Jerusalem: ³ “For twenty-three years, from the thirteenth year of Josiah the son of Amon, king of Judah, to this day, the word of the Lord has come to me, and I have spoken persistently to you, but you have not listened. ⁴ You have neither listened nor inclined your ears to hear, although the Lord persistently sent to you all his servants the prophets, ⁵ saying, ‘Turn now, every one of you, from his evil way and evil deeds, and dwell upon the land that the Lord has given to you and your fathers from of old and forever. ⁶ *Do not go after other gods to serve and worship them, or provoke me to anger with the work of your hands.* Then I will do you no harm.’ ⁷ Yet you have not listened to me, declares the Lord, that you might provoke me to anger with the work of your hands to your own harm.

⁸ “Therefore thus says the Lord of hosts: Because you have not obeyed my words, ⁹ behold, I will send for all the tribes of the north, declares the Lord, and for Nebuchadnezzar the king of Babylon, my servant, and I will bring them against this land and its inhabitants, and against all these surrounding nations. I will devote them to destruction, and make them a horror, a hissing, and an everlasting desolation. ¹⁰ Moreover, I will banish from them the voice of mirth and the voice of gladness, the voice of the bridegroom and the voice of the bride, the grinding of the millstones and the light of the lamp. ¹¹ This whole land shall become a ruin and a waste, and these nations shall serve the king of Babylon seventy years. ¹² Then after seventy years are completed, I will punish the king of Babylon and that

nation, the land of the Chaldeans, for their iniquity, declares the Lord, making the land an everlasting waste. 13 I will bring upon that land all the words that I have uttered against it, everything written in this book, which Jeremiah prophesied against all the nations. ¹⁴ For many nations and great kings shall make slaves even of them, and I will recompense them according to their deeds and the work of their hands.”

Jeremiah predicts the 70 years of Babylonian captivity, and draws the connection that Judah persisted in idolatry

Chronicles 36:20 comments on that prophecy

²⁰ He took into exile in Babylon those who had escaped from the sword, and they became servants to him and to his sons until the establishment of the kingdom of Persia, ²¹ to fulfill the word of the Lord by the mouth of Jeremiah, until the land had enjoyed its Sabbaths. *All the days that it lay desolate it kept Sabbath, to fulfill seventy years.*

Chronicles draws the connection that the Babylonian captivity was related to failure to keep the Sabbath (and the other OT economic policies, including Shemitah and Jubilee)

9 Samuel - Kings - Chronicles

10 Matthew

Matthew compares Jesus to Herod the Great. (Luke compares him to Caesar)

Matt 25 Ten Virgins

3/119: Gate of Hell - Matthew 16

3/123: Heat of the Day Matthew 20

10.1 3/125: Matthew 21

Two sons: Zadok and Abiathar

Parable of Vineyard:

Isaiah 5

Saducees when they heard the parable assumed that the tenants in the parable are Rome, but Jesus is calling them out as the wicked tenants

The “fruit” of the vineyard is the good works of Israel

Perspective of the Saducees is clear in their response: He will bring those wretches to a wretched end, and he will rent the vineyard to other tenants who will give him his share of the crop at harvest.

Isaiah 61:1

The Spirit of the Sovereign Lord is on me,
because the Lord has anointed me
to proclaim good news to the poor.
He has sent me to bind up the brokenhearted,
to proclaim freedom for the captives
and release from darkness for the prisoners,^[a]
² to proclaim the year of the Lord's favor
and the day of vengeance of our God,
to comfort all who mourn,
³ and provide for those who grieve in Zion—
to bestow on them a crown of beauty

instead of ashes,
the oil of joy
instead of mourning,
and a garment of praise
instead of a spirit of despair.
They will be called oaks of righteousness,
a planting of the Lord
for the display of his splendor.

- ⁴ They will rebuild the ancient ruins
and restore the places long devastated;
they will renew the ruined cities
that have been devastated for generations.
⁵ Strangers will shepherd your flocks;
foreigners will work your fields and vineyards.
⁶ And you will be called priests of the Lord,
you will be named ministers of our God.
You will feed on the wealth of nations,
and in their riches you will boast.

10.1.1 Parable of Wedding Banquet

God is throwing a party, but in His way and at His time.

Man without wedding clothes - someone who doesn't recognize God's design, desire, or authority

cf Zephaniah 1

[Zep 1:4-12 ESV] ⁴ "I will stretch out my hand against Judah and against all the inhabitants of Jerusalem; and I will cut off from this place the remnant of Baal and the name of the **idolatrous priests** along with the priests, ⁵ those who bow down on the roofs to the host of the heavens, those who bow down and swear to the LORD and yet swear by Milcom, ⁶ those who have turned back from following the LORD, who do not seek the LORD or inquire of him." ⁷ Be silent before the Lord GOD! For the day of the LORD is near; the LORD has prepared a sacrifice and consecrated his guests. ⁸ And on the day of the LORD's sacrifice— "I will punish the officials and the king's sons and all who array themselves in **foreign attire**. ⁹ On that day I will punish everyone who leaps over the threshold, and those who fill their master's house with violence and fraud. ¹⁰ "On that day," declares the LORD, "a cry will be heard from the Fish Gate, a wail from the Second Quarter, a loud crash from the hills. ¹¹ Wail, O inhabitants of the Mortar! For all the traders are no more; all who weigh out silver are cut off. ¹² At that time I will search Jerusalem with lamps, and I will punish the men who are complacent, those who say in their hearts, 'The LORD will not do good, nor will he do ill.'

10.2 3/126: Trapped by a Question: Matthew

Good Samaritan

Hillel vs Shammai

Render unto Cesaer

11 Roman History

11.1 Augustus Caesar (Octavian)

Adopted some of Julius Caesar, assassinated in 44BC.

Defeated Mark Anthony and Cleopatra in maritime battle of Actium 31BC

Title Augustus conferred in 27BC by Roman Senate

11.2 Tiberius Caesar

Succeeded Augustus in 14AD

11.3 Caligula

Succeeded Tiberius in 37 AD but was mentally unstable

11.4 Claudius

Rose to power in 41 AD and invaded Britain in 43AD

Expelled Jews from Rome in 49 AD

11.5 Nero

Came to power in 54 AD as 17-year old stepson of Claudius

Blamed Christians for Great Fire of Rome in 64AD.

Paul and Peter were executed by Nero during the Romano-Jewish war of 66 AD

11.6 Vespasian

Came to power in 68AD after Nero's suicide

11.7 Titus

Came to power in 79AD. Destroyed the Temple in Jerusalem in 70 AD to end Jewish war

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Matthew compares Jesus to Herod the Great. (Luke compares him to Caesar)

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Man without wedding clothes - someone who doesn't recognize God's design, desire, or authority

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12.2 3/126: Trapped by a Question: Matthew

Good Samaritan

Hillel vs Shammai

Render unto Cesaer

13 Revelation

Apocalyptic literature - use of pictures and images to convey a message of hope to the present day

Zechariah (BEMA 68) - source

7 Stars - Reference to Greco-Roman culture and pagan understanding of the zodiac: Sun, Moon, Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn

Written ?during reign of Domitian

13.0.1 Ephesus - BEMA158

Revelation is written after Ephesians. In the interim, Mt Vesuvius erupted in AD 79. Oracle at Delphi said it was due to destruction of the temple in Jerusalem. Domitian responds by trying to kill the Jews and their God -> persecution.

First love of Ephesus - Was it Jesus? Or the unity that we see in the letter to the Ephesians?

13.0.2 Smyrna. {BEMA176}

Known for production of myrrh. Obsessed with death

Port city (modern day Izmir) predates Rome. Temple to Rome and Roma.

Jewish contingent did not accept the inclusion of the Gentiles and excluded the Gentiles from the Jewish exclusion with the Romans (allowed Jews to pay a tax and be exempt from the requirement to worship Caesar)

13.1 Resources:

Christ and the Caesars <https://archive.org/details/20191113christandthecaesars>

Christians: The first 200 years. Vol 1: The Veil is Torn Vol 2: A Pinch of Incense

7 cities of the apocalypse and Roman Culture by Roland H Worth Jr

Days of Vengeance

Part III

CMDA

14 Mentorship academy

14.1 Curriculum

Retreat October 10, 2026 (?Zoom)

Monthly mentoring sessions 1hr Zoom meetings in June/jam Four Zoom meetings

14.2 Residency environment

Education + Service

Residency selection - How do residents choose a specialty?

- Geograpy
- Quality of training Academic reputation

1999 - Unions 2003 - Duty Hours restrictions 2004 - NRBP Anti-trust - exempted by Congress

2011 - Residents pay FICA

14.2.1 Current priorities in residency selection

Current resident satisfaction Level of concern program has for trainee' Perception of "fit"

14.3 Dehumanization

Corporitization

burnout - bilimoria □ Look for NEJM article by Bilimoria

14.4 Anti-humanisitb

Prejudice against

Optimal learnin environment

⇒ Professional Identity/Community of Practice. Cruess Acad Med 2014

How can mentors foster professional identity development?

Barna: Discipleship is holding each other accountable - Supportive

Part IV

Carl Truman

15 Desecration of Man

16 Strange New World

Part V

Jon Tyson

17 Jon Tyson

Christ Has No Body

Christ has no body but yours, No hands, no feet on earth but yours, Yours are the eyes with which he looks Compassion on this world, Yours are the feet with which he walks to do good, Yours are the hands, with which he blesses all the world. Yours are the hands, yours are the feet, Yours are the eyes, you are his body. Christ has no body now but yours, No hands, no feet on earth but yours, Yours are the eyes with which he looks compassion on this world. Christ has no body now on earth but yours.

Teresa of Avila (1515–1582). Born in Spain, Teresa entered a Carmelite convent when she was eighteen, and later earned a reputation as a mystic, reformer, and writer who experienced divine visions. She founded a convent, and wrote the book *The Way of Perfection* for her nuns. Other important books by her include her *Autobiography* and *The Interior Castle*.

18 Man Year

18.1 Challenge 1

Part VI

NT Wright

19 Suprised by Hope

20 Surprised by Hope

20.1 Session 2

20.2 Salvation -

Being saved *for* something rather than just being saved *from* something

Rom 8: Whole creation awaiting salvation

19 For the anxious longing of the creation waits eagerly for the revealing of the sons of God. 20 For the creation was subjected to futility, not willingly, but because of Him who subjected it, [i]n hope 21 that the creation itself also will be set free from its slavery to corruption into the freedom of the glory of the children of God. 22 For we know that the whole creation groans and suffers the pains of childbirth together until now. 23 And not only this, but also we ourselves, having the first fruits of the Spirit, even we ourselves groan within ourselves, waiting eagerly for our adoption as sons, the redemption of our body. 24 For in hope we have been saved, but hope that is seen is not hope; for who hopes for what he already sees? 25 But if we hope for what we do not see, with perseverance we wait eagerly for it.

20.3 Judgement: God putting everything right

Paul in Athens: Acts 17

Being then God's offspring, hwe ought not to think that the divine being is like gold or silver or stone, an image formed by the art and imagination of man. 30 iThe times of ignorance jGod overlooked, but know he lcommands all people everywhere to repent, 31 because he has fixed ma day on which nhe will judge the world oin righteousness by a man whom he has appointed; and pof this he has given assurance to all qby raising him from the dead."

Messiah will put the world right as God's agent

Psalm 2

“I will announce the decree of the Lord: He said to Me, ‘You are My Son, Today I have fathered You. 8 Ask it of Me, and I will certainly give the nations as Your inheritance, And the ends of the earth as Your possession. 9 You shall break them with a rod of iron, You shall shatter them like earthenware.’” 10 Now then, you kings, use insight; Let yourselves be instructed, you judges of the earth. 11 Serve the Lord with reverence And rejoice with trembling. 12 Kiss the Son, that He not be angry and you perish on the way, For His wrath may be kindled quickly. How blessed are all who take refuge in Him!

Psalm 9

But the Lord sits as King forever; He has established His throne for judgment, 8 And He will judge the world in righteousness; He will execute judgment for the peoples fairly. 9 The Lord will also be a stronghold for the oppressed, A stronghold in times of trouble; 10 And those who know Your name will put their trust in You, For You, Lord, have not abandoned those who seek You.

Psalm 98

May the sea roar and all it contains, The world and those who dwell in it. 8 May the rivers clap their hands, May the mountains sing together for joy 9 Before the Lord, for He is coming to judge the earth; He will judge the world with righteousness And the peoples with fairness.

Genesis - Man designed to reflect God’s goodness into the world = made in the image of God (and to reflect praises back to God)

After Fall, God brings a plan for restoration that involves a faithful human being. Jesus is the truly human being.

I Corinthians 15 - Resurrection

21 For since by a man death came, by a Man also came the resurrection of the dead. 22 For as in Adam all die, so also in Christ all will be made alive. 23 But each in his own order: Christ the first fruits, after that those who are Christ’s at His coming, 24 then comes the end, when He hands over the kingdom to our God and Father, when He has abolished all rule and all authority and power. 25 For He must reign until He has put all His enemies under His feet. 26 The last enemy that will be abolished is death. 27 For He has put all things in subjection under His feet. But when He says, “All things are put in subjection,” it is clear that this excludes the Father who put all things in subjection to Him. 28 When all things are subjected to Him, then the Son Himself will also be subjected to the One who subjected all things to Him, so that God may be all in all.

The last enemy is death itself. Death is the enemy. Death is not defeated if we simply die and go to heaven.

Eph 2:8-10

By grace you have been saved . We are God's workmanship (lit poema = poem)

We are the instruments for God's redeeming work

God's judgement - God sorting it all out => means of God's salvation

We are bearers of wise healing creative judgement

20.4 Session 3

(church architecture - Kingdom of God - happens on earth as in heaven)

Jesus began launching the work of God's will on earth as it is in heaven

Two views of Jesus's second coming:

- Coming to complete the work of the Kingdom of God advancing in the earth
- Coming to snatch us away with Him to another place (heaven)

Part VII

Turkey

21 Turkey Trip

Notes from [Walking the Text](#) trip to Turkey September 12-24, 2021

- Day 1: Tuesday 9/14
 - [Vaclav Museum](#)
 - [Antalya Museum](#)
 - [Perga Muratpasa](#)
- Day 2: 9/15 Weds Gorguorta Mh (outside Yalvac). Museum
 - Colossae????
- Day 3: 9/16 Thurs Denizli Frontinus Gate and Heiropolos (spring). Pamukkale Pools 12pm. Denizli 2pm
 - Laodicea
- Day 4: 9/17 Fri
 - Philadelphia Tetracylon Aphordisease Antik Kenti. Sean Jean Slisesi. Museum with god-fearer inscription. Sebastion reliefs (in museum). Sebastion on site 10am. Huge stadium 11am
 - Aphrodisias city of Marble
- Day 5: 9/18 Sat Manisa (Vineyardn 9am). Sardis 11am.Artemis Tapinagi 12pm. Small city park Ragip Bey Mh 5pm
- Day 6: 9/19 Sunday
 - Ulucamii Mh 9am.
 - Kurtulus Mh 9:30am.
 - Theater and temple to Dionysus 10am
 - Selcuk Mn 12:20pm.
 - Zafer Mn (Aesculayeon).
 - Pergamum
 - Smyrna 4pm
- Sabbath
- Day 8: 9/21 Tuesday
 - Ataturk Mh 10am.

- Mt Croessus.
 - Selcuk (Ephesus) museum 1pm. 2 statues of Artemis.
 - Ephesus Ruins (first day) Pierene
- Day 9: 9/22 Wednesday.
 - St Jean Kilisesi. Focus on Revelations.
 - Villas in Ephesus.
- Day 10: 9/23 Thursday. Didyma. Miletos. Priene?

22 Day 1

22.1 Devotion

Who are you? What are you doing here?

Ez 40:4

And the man said to me, “Son of man, look with your eyes, and hear with your ears, and set your heart upon all that I shall show you, for you were brought here in order that I might show it to you. Declare all that you see to the house of Israel.”

22.2 History Timeline

22.2.1 Alexander the Great

Alexander the Great defeats Persians

301BC Battle of Ipsus. After his death, kingdom was split between four generals:

- Lysimachus - Western Asia Minor
- Seleucus I Nicator - Eastern Asia Minor and North Syria (later attacks Lysimachus)
- Ptolemy - South Syria and Egypt
- Cassander - Macedonia

Israel alternated control by either Ptolemy or Seleucus. Antiochus IV (Seleucid) offends Jews with the abomination of desolation

22.2.2 Roman Empire

Problem: How to forge a Roman identity across the empire?

Virgil commissioned to write the Aeneid as an origin story for Rome starting with the burning of Troy (where Homer's Iliad leaves off). “The ox and the lion will lie down together”

22.2.3 Juius Caesar

61BC - Julius Caesar comes to power. Enemy was Pompeii, and a civil war broke out. Pompeii was subsequently assassinated in Egypt.

59BC - comet appears and this is claimed as a sign that Caesar is divine.

44BC - Julius Caesar was asasinated by Bruts and Cassius.

Caesar's will names Octavian, his nephew, as next roman leader.

22.2.4 Octavian (Caesar Augustus)

Octavian assumes power at age 18

43BC - Triumverate: Octavian, Mark Anthony, Lepidus. Lepidus is subsequently dismissed.

31BC - Battle of Actium - Octavian defeats Mark Anthony. Mark Anthony had married Cleopatra, with whom Julius Caesar had ha a relationship.

29BC - Pergamum proposes to build a temple for Octavian. He agrees, with the condition that temples are built for Roma and Julius Caessar in Ephesus.

27BC - Octavian offers to yield power to senate, which subsequently make him the first emporer

22.2.5 Emperors

- Caesar Augustus 27BC - 14AD
- Tiberius 14AD - 37AD
- Caligula 37AD - 41AD
- Claudius 41AD - 54AD
- Nero 54AD - 68AD
- Vaspasian 68AD - 79AD
- Titus 79AD - 81AD
-

22.2.6 Roman Triumph

- Required killing at least 5,000 enemy soldiers (civil war did not qualify)
- INitially could be arranged in honor of a general, but later was only used to celebrate the emperor.
- Designed to emphasize divine approval of the emperor
- Order of procession:
 - 1) Praetorian guard (legions were not permitted in Rome except on permission of emperor)
 - 2) Caesar dressed like a god with a purple robe, golden wreath, sceptor or reed in his hands
 - 3) Soldiers “Hail Caesar”
 - 4) Procession to Forum
 - 5) Sacrificial bull with the instrument of his death (eg hammer)
 - 6) Conclusion at Capetine Hill
 - 7) Caesar offered cup of wine as libation - poured out on head of bull
 - 8) Bull is then sacrificed
 - 9) Caesar ascends (with someone on left and right)
 - 10) Look for divine sign - flock or birds or an eclipse

John’s gospel draws parallele between triumph and crucifixion

Mark 15:6

Mark 15:17

Mark 15:18

Mark 15:20

Mark 14

Mark 15:24

Mark 15:28

Mark 15:29

I Cor 2

Col 2:15

Mark 1

Priene Calendar Inscription “beginng of good news of Caesar son of God”

At crucifixion, no one was able to figure out true identity of Jesus, which required a Roman centurion

I Cor 4:15 Leads us as captives

We are the aroma...

22.3 Regions

22.3.1 Syria

Modern day Palestine (Levant). Province of Syria important to Romans to protect them from the Parthians in the East and from Jewish rebellion in Judea. Quirinius appointed Syria Governor in AD 6¹

22.3.2 Antioch on the Orontes

After death of Alexander the Greek in 306BC, Antigonus I controls Antioch. After

22.3.3 Roman Gods

Artemis

Zeus

Hygei

Apolo

Hermes - Messenger. God of Commerce

Hercules/Paracles

Aesculapyus - God of Medicine. symbol of snake- who would shed skin and regerate.

22.3.4 Helenism

Alexander the Great - Was a missionary spreading a message of Helenism

- Changed culture and sports
- Brought an individualistic mentality
- Sex and alcohol to excess

¹Wilson, p58

23 Antalya

23.1 History

- Founded by Attalus II
- 190BC Antiochus III defeated at battle of Magnesia by Romans + Pergamenes against Seleucid kin For events of Antiochus III See Daniel 11:10-19
- 188 BC Treaty of Apamea
- 133 BC - Attalus III willed lands to Rome, but Atalya remained free
- 64 BC - Rome annexed Atalya by Pompey
- 40-39 BC Parthians occupied Antioch on the Orantes

23.2 Saul

- Acts 7:5-8 They laid their coats at the feet of Saul
- Acts 8:1-3 Saul approved of their execution. He put believers in prison.
- Acts 21:39 (arrested on temple mount)
- Acts 22:3

23.2.1 Tarsus

171BC citizens of Tarsus began receiving Roman citizenship. 64BC Capital of Cilicia. Site of largest philosophy school in the empire

23.2.2 Gamaliel

Acts 22:3 Studied under Gamaliel in Jerusalem (required \$)

Gamaliel - First rabbi (my teacher) given title of rabboni (our teacher)

- Grandson of Hillel, who died when Jesus was 20. More tolerant and progressive than Shammai. Jesus tended to favor teaching of Hillel (except about marriage)

Acts 5:30-40 Gamaliel (honored by all):

“If (the Way) is from God, you will not be able to stop it, because you cannot oppose God.

Acts 9:1 Saul - asked for letters for Damascus (150 miles away) to take them as prisoners

Acts 22:3

Acts 22:3-21

Acts 20:9-18

Galatians 1:3-7

24 Antalya

Acts 9:34 Damascus Saul, Saul

Ez 1:28 Rainow / Glory -> fell face down

Acts 9:15 GO -> proclaim my names to the Gentiles

Gal 1:15-16 God set me apart from my mother's womb

Is 49 Called me from my mother's womb -> light to the Gentiles

Jer 1:5

Paul arrives in town -> goes to synagogue first

Acts 9:9

Acts 9:4

Jonah - 3 days in the whale

Fighting against the goads

Gamiel -> if the Way is from God, you cannot resist it, because you would be resisting God

Playwright from the day (Euripides): futility of resisting the gods- kick against the goads.

Gal 1: Gospel is not of human origin. As zealous as any

24.1 Zeal

Hebrew: Kana' Phineas Num 25 EliJah I kings 19:10 I have zealously served the Lord Zealots - politica group in the Inter-testimental period - Zealous and stopping at nothing - Maccabean revolt AD6

Ps 69:8-9

24.2 Paul went to Arabia (=wilderness)

I Kings 19:15 Lord says to Elijah: return to wilderness

Gal 1:17 I did not go up to Jerusalem but went to Arabia

Gal 4:25 Hagar is Mt Sinai in Arabia

(Province of Arabia is Siani penninsula - NOT Saudi Arabia)

24.3 Wilderness

God meets people in the wilderness - Moses, Issrael, Elijah, Paul

Paul spends 3 years in the wilderness getting his theology right. He was zealous in persecuting the Way, but needed to re-orient his theology.

Acts 13:13 Pamphylia

Acts 14:25-26 Perga -> Atylia -> Antioch

#Ephesus

24.4 Geography

Mount Coressus - Hiked

Mount Pion - across valled with two humps

City with castle - Mount Ayasuluk

To left -river at base of mountains Cayster river

Oval - marshlike - Harbor - at base of where we hiked - silting of Cister river. Water is not now 3 miles away

Teater at base of mount Peon could hold 20,000 people

Road goes from amphitheater to harbor = "Harbor Street"

Teater to covered building - Marblestreet

Building to smaller theater - Curets streeets = Curetes Street. Between teaheater and flat room - Giant swaure with trees in middle = agora - Commercial agoara

Big square with theater on it Civic Agora

Perga - One agora

Hiked Mount Caresus

Mount Aslaouke in distance

Three major roads - harbor/marble/cure street Commercial and state agora

Magnesin gate - near bend in road outside parking lot.

Started our hike when wall goes down back side.

5 mile wall built by Lysimachus to protect city

Stadium on NorthEast of ed

Artemesis temple largest in the world only a column remains. Off North end of Mount Peoples headed towards Mount Ayosolupe. Wasn't in city center because something fell from sky - probably piece of meteor. Built temple in swampy area. Birthplace of Artemesis was behind Mount Caresus in Mount Ortygia.

Ephesus means "desirable"

Huntington College Mark Fairchild - similar to Mark Wilson

Origin myth - Amazons founded Ephesus and cult of Artemis. Amazons are Hittites. From Black Sea region.

Amazons - all-woman tribe amazing archers.

Ephesus founded 1900BC

Local peoples 1100 to 1000 BC (during time of David - Uriah the Hittite is from Turkey)

Greek colonists -> Greek influence. Settlement situated city off North side of Mount Peon about 1000BC until 550BC (off North end of Mt Peon.

560BC - Croesus - Lydian King takes control of city, then moves city further towards Mount Ayosolupe.

Croesus is rich - See notes from Sardis -

546 - Croesus is owned by Cyrus the Persian

334 BC conquered by Alexander the Great. Preserves city (Macedonia control)

Alexander the great dies -> generals fight.

294 BC Lysimachus gains control of Ephesus. Lysimachus moves city to between Mount Caresus and Mount Peon.. Lysimachus builds 5 mile wall to protect city.

282 BC Seleucids defeat Lysimachus.

Philetarus city steward of Pergamum. Sides with Seleucids, who defeats Lysimachus

Battle of Magnesia

Celusids lose to Romans and Attelids

133BC Attelid III dies and wills empire to Rome.

Added to Province of Asia 129 BC

First Century AD: Ephesus supplants Pergamum as foremost city in Asia. Fourth largest city in Roman empire behind Rome, Syrian Antioch, Alexandria. Ephesus and Syrian Antioch are similar in size. Minimum 250,000 people in Ephesus in Paul's days

Leadership in Ephesus:

Acts 18:18-21

Paul stayed many days, set sail (from Corinth) with Aquilla and Priscilla.

Paul was trying to come to Ephesus, but prevented by Holy Spirit. On Second missionary journey, drops off Aquilla and Priscilla.

Acts 14:24-28

Jew named Apollos. Had been instructed in the way of the Lord. Knew only baptism of John...proving from the scriptures that Jesus was the Christ

Acts 19:1

While Apollos was in Corinth. Paul took interior road (3rd Journey - has with him since Lystra = Timothy)

Acts 20:31

Be on your guard. For 3 years I have never stopped warning you with tears.

Acts 19:22

Timothy stayed in Asia and pastored Church

II Tim 4:11-13

Only Luke with me. Get Mark. I sent Tychicus to Ephesus.

Tychicus is pastoring in Ephesus. Timothy was buried at Ephesus. Luke is buried at Ephesus. After this. John comes to Ephesus and becomes pastor in Ephesus. At foot of cross - John behold you mother, Mother, behold your son.

Church of Mary. Mother of Jesus died here.

Long list of people pastoring in Ephesus.

Ephesus a gateway city for Troas to the East. Connect Aegean to Asia

Only more highly travelled area is Israel.

Aprodesian 1750 people in Bouleterion

Built 2C AD

Constructed in Hellenistir period (Begins with Alexander the Great)

= 334 BC and followings.

Boule meeting - only members of counici could enter and vote. Otherwise could be used as Odeon (lecture hall)

Acts 19:

18 Months in Corinth -> Ephesius. Leaves Priscilla and Aquilla

Apollos - needs to hear about holy spirit.

Appolos sthen goes elsewhere

Acts 19:1

Apollos at Corinth. Paul took road through interior to Ephesus. Have you heard of Holy Sprit> -> Jhn's Baptism. ththey were baptized in name of Jesus and holy spirit am on them and they spoke in tongues and prophesized

John ws populatJohn'smission was to prepare the way for the messiah. Baptism of repentence.

v4

Third missionary journey - 54-55AD, 25 yeasers after resurrection - people still are talking about John's baptism.

Story of Jesus had still not been procolaimed in Ephesus.

First journey 46-48

Acts 15 council 49-50

2nd Journey 50-53

Third journey 53-54-57 AD.

Arrested in Jerusalem

Cesearii

Rome in 60-61

61-2 Paul released

Light chain arrest Pilat 26-36 AD -> felxi festus -> agrippa

When in Rome, he is not in a prison cell. He has a right to appeal to Caesar.

Being guarded by a soldier. 64 - our

Rearrested in 67 -> brought to Nero. Paul martyred by Nero 67=68 AD

For 3 years I warned you

9 months unaccounted for

3 mo synagogue - 2 mon lecture hall -> gap 9 months ->

... so that all the Jews and Greeks heard the word of the Lord.

Seven sons of Sceva. Jesus I know, and I know about Paul, but who are you?

Magical center of Roman empire. Curses, Voodoo, incantations. Paul has a power that is coming from a different source of power.

Drachama = 1 days wage. 50,000 drachamas went up in flames

Word spread widely and grew in power. Handkerchief gig only happens in Ephesus. A number who had practiced sorcery

Huge bonfire " we are starting church" see also in Timothy, Ephesians, Corinthians. Start of church amidst chaos.

False teaching is going to be a huge problem.

Sorcery != cult worship.

note lions feed off flanking stairs

Alexander offered money to help rebuild, and offered money for rebuilding.

Four times size of Parthenon. 400+ feet long, 200+ feet wide. Forest of 127 columns

Several functions

pilgrims banking government inscriptions Asylum Debtors Poor and Needy

Controlled 70,000 acres of agriculture.

#Theater - started being renovated in 60AD

Ima Kevea + media keea + summa keveah

Artemesian = Artemis temple One of 7 wonders of the ancient world

1000s of pilgrims came for Spring festival of Artemis

At new testament time, temple was 5th one built on the site. Built and rebuilt, renovated.

Located at site of meteorite falling. Traditional birthplace behind Mount Parnassus.

July 21, 356 BC Herostratus burned down temple with oil lamps and rags. Ruler banned use of his name, and banned "Herostratic fame"

Dishonoring that goddess would let the temple burn. Date is birthdate of Alexander the Great
MOTHER goddess left her post to attend the birth of Alexander the Great

Richest sanctuary apart for oracle at Delphi

Ortesia - sacred grove where she was born = Ortesia described as “paradise” = paradeisos
There arose a great disturbance about The Way. Demetrius a silversmith brought in small
little business for the skilled workers “You know, that we received a good business, and how
Paul has convinced... practically the whole province of Asia .

Acts 19

They shouted for two hours: “Great is Artemis” in the theater

Preitanus (City Clerk) quieted the crowd. (It took him two hours to get there)

People of Ephesus, doesn't all the world know that Ephesus is neocorus of the temple of Artemis
and her image that fell from heaven. Since these facts are undeniable.

Though they have neither robbed temples or blasphemed...

IF then, Demetrius and his associates have a grievance, they can bring it to the procounsel.

As it is, we are in danger of being charged with rioting, since there is no reason for it. With
that, he dismissed the assembly.

Paul was having a massive impact on the city, not by tearing down their gods, but by elevating
the gospel.

25 Colossae

25.1 Geography

Mount Cadmus is source of water

25.2 Culture

Red-purple dye = Colossinus

25.3 History

Tell not yet excavated

480BC Xerxes (Persian) invaded

Leading city 5/6 Century BC

300BC Heropolis built

60 AD - Earthquake decimated

5/6 Century AC -> people moved out

25.4 Biblical References

Paul took road through interior to Ephesus on 3rd missionary journey Paul never met Colossians

Letter written by Paul from Rome - Delivered by Tychicus

25.5 Ephesians 4: Instructions to Families

25.5.1 Domestic Relationships in Roman culture

Aristotle Politics: Household management in its perfect form: master + slave, husband + wife,

449BC - Law on 12 Tablets

Pater Familia - held power of life and death for household members

25.5.2 Ephesians 4

Paul didn't invent Roman household code. Instructions are given first to wives, then husbands (pater familias), then children. Addressing wives first was unheard of in Roman society.

25.5.3 Marriage types

- With the hand - Man brings a woman into his home (and she is subject to him) - 50%
- without the hand - Wife is not under husband's authority

25.5.4 Instructions to husbands

Husbands - Agapao - love without expecting anything in return. This was revolutionary in Roman culture, which was highly transactional. Many marriages were politically expedient

Work for master - LORD: Kuios

25.5.5 Slavery

Paul couldn't abolish slavery, as the whole economy of the Roman Empire depended upon slavery.

25.5.6 Instructions to children

Children - when asked to obey - assumes agency

26 Perga

27 Culture

70AD Gladiators introduced to Perga - Generally a spectacle associated with a festival.

12,000 spectators

Jail was used simply to hold prisoners over until execution.

Romans were first to build free-standing theaters (Greeks built them into the hillside)

Outer Gates - 300AD Inner gates XXBC

Baths - Most popular form of leisure activity

Greeks - gymnasium - used primarily for exercise. gymnos = naked

Romans - More emphasis on waters. 867 bath houses in Rome

“Baths, wine, and sex spoil our body and make our life”

Apodyterium - changing room

27.0.1 Agora

Civic agora

Commercial agora. Inside square - statue of Hermes

Cardo - Usually north-south main street Decumanus - east-west main street

Nymphaeum of Kystros

27.1 Barnabas and Saul

Acts 13

Acts 14:25

Set apart Barnabas and Saul

Acts 12:25

Acts 11:36

Acts 9:27 Barnabas brought Paul to council

Acts 11:22 Barnabas -> antioch. News reaches Jerusalem, which sends Barnabas

Acts 11:25-6: Believers were first called Christians in Antioch

Col 4:10

Acts xx

I Pet 5:13 Peter calls John Mark a son

Acts 13:X Pathos -> Perga

I Tim 4:11

Why Barnabas? Acts 4. He was a Levite native of Cyprus. Someone was needed who was trustworthy (vs Ananias and Siphira who lied about the process)

Barnabas vouched for Paul

Paul was culturally bilingual

One year of preparation -> scattered (?)

Why John Mark?. Mark was cousin of Barnabas and knew Jesus' life

Acts 4:36-42

Spirit didn't tell them where to go

Crucifixion was AD30. First missionary journey was 56AD

Why did John Mark leave?

- Too old
- Too Roman
- Sideways relationship with Paul

Paul confronts Peter on failing to associate with Gentiles

Did John Mark go back to avoid ministry to Gentiles?

John Mark writes gospel/founds church in Alexandria Egypt.

Mark's gospel recounts Peter's story

John Mark was one of the 120 but didn't have first-hand knowledge of the crucifixion

27.2 Common mistakes in interpreting the Bible

90% of stories depend upon location

What other events have happened at that location? - Allusion to geography

Acts 15:36

Paul to Barnabas: Let's visit

Right place to be is in the center of God's will, although not necessarily the safest.

II Tim

Get Mark and bring him to me, for he is helpful for my ministry

28 Vaclav

28.1 _____ Site

Nymphaeum - Water source. Message: Gods and Goddesses bring you your water

Worship of the gods: Underlying concept is that the gods are angry and need to be appeased.

- Christians seen as atheists because they did not worship Roman gods
- Jews were offered exemption to worship of Roman gods by Caesar Augustus
- Jews later told the Romans that Christians were “not one of us”, and should not qualify for the exemption.

Question: As a Christian, do you drink the water in the Nymphaem?

28.1.1 Sarcophagus

Dead buried above ground

29 Vaclav museum

29.1 Paul encountering Jesus on the Damascus Road

29.2 Paul in Antioch in Pisidia

Acts 13:

Now Paul and his companions set sail from Paphos and came to Perga in Pamphylia. And John left them and returned to Jerusalem, 14 but they went on from Perga and came to Antioch in Pisidia. And on the Sabbath day they went into the synagogue and sat down. 15 After the reading from the Law and the Prophets, the rulers of the synagogue sent a message to them, saying, “Brothers, if you have any word of encouragement for the people, say it.” 16 So Paul stood up, and motioning with his hand said:

29.3 Paul and Barnabas switch roles

29.3.1 Aristotlean Rhetoric

- 1) Resortium - INtroduction
- 2) Narratio - Background (vv 17-25)
- 3) Propositio - Thesis (v26)
- 4) Probato - Evidence (vv27-37) 5: Piratio - Closing argumentn (vv38-41)

Paul was made to bring the gospel to the gentiles.

Acts 13:xx-xx

“Men of Israel and you who fear God, listen. 17 The God of this people Israel chose our fathers and made the people great during their stay in the land of Egypt, and with uplifted arm he led them out of it. 18 And for about forty years he put up with[b] them in the wilderness. 19 And after destroying seven nations in the land of Canaan, he gave them their land as an inheritance. 20 All this took about 450 years. And after that he gave them judges until Samuel the prophet. 21 Then they

asked for a king, and God gave them Saul the son of Kish, a man of the tribe of Benjamin, for forty years. 22 And when he had removed him, he raised up David to be their king, of whom he testified and said, 'I have found in David the son of Jesse a man after my heart, who will do all my will.' 23 Of this man's offspring God has brought to Israel a Savior, Jesus, as he promised. 24 Before his coming, John had proclaimed a baptism of repentance to all the people of Israel. 25 And as John was finishing his course, he said, 'What do you suppose that I am? I am not he. No, but behold, after me one is coming, the sandals of whose feet I am not worthy to untie.' 26 "Brothers, sons of the family of Abraham, and those among you who fear God, to us has been sent the message of this salvation. 27 For those who live in Jerusalem and their rulers, because they did not recognize him nor understand the utterances of the prophets, which are read every Sabbath, fulfilled them by condemning him. 28 And though they found in him no guilt worthy of death, they asked Pilate to have him executed. 29 And when they had carried out all that was written of him, they took him down from the tree and laid him in a tomb. 30 But God raised him from the dead, 31 and for many days he appeared to those who had come up with him from Galilee to Jerusalem, who are now his witnesses to the people. 32 And we bring you the good news that what God promised to the fathers, 33 this he has fulfilled to us their children by raising Jesus, as also it is written in the second Psalm, "'You are my Son, today I have begotten you.' Ad as for the fact that he raised him from the dead, no more to return to corruption, he has spoken in this way, "'I will give you the holy and sure blessings of David.' Therefore he says also in another psalm, "'You will not let your Holy One see corruption.' For David, after he had served the purpose of God in his own generation, fell asleep and was laid with his fathers and saw corruption, 37 but he whom God raised up did not see corruption. 38 Let it be known to you therefore, brothers, that through this man forgiveness of sins is proclaimed to you, 39 and by him everyone who believes is freed from everything from which you could not be freed by the law of Moses. 40 Beware, therefore, lest what is said in the Prophets should come about: "'Look, you scoffers, be astounded and perish; for I am doing a work in your days, work that you will not believe, even if one tells it to you.' "

Is 49:6

"It is too light a thing that you should be my servant to raise up the tribes of Jacob and to bring back the preserved of Israel; I will make you as a light for the nations, that my salvation may reach to the end of the earth."

Yalvac museum

Resguste - Deeds of Caesar

Ovid - Metamorphasis 8AD Baccus and Philemon

- Wine never runs out.

Acts 14:21

But Jews came from Antioch and Iconium, and having persuaded the crowds, they stoned Paul and dragged him out of the city, supposing that he was dead. But when the disciples gathered about him, he rose up and entered the city, and on the next day he went on with Barnabas to Derbe.

Paul wasnt giving up!

42 As they went out, the people begged that these things might be told them the next Sabbath. 43 And after the meeting of the synagogue broke up, many Jews and devout converts to Judaism followed Paul and Barnabas, who, as they spoke with them, urged them to continue in the grace of God. The next Sabbath almost the whole city gathered to hear the word of the Lord. 45 But when the Jews[d] saw the crowds, they were filled with jealousy and began to contradict what was spoken by Paul, reviling him. 46 And Paul and Barnabas spoke out boldly, saying, “It was necessary that the word of God be spoken first to you. Since you thrust it aside and judge yourselves unworthy of eternal life, behold, we are turning to the Gentiles. 47 For so the Lord has commanded us, saying, “‘I have made you a light for the Gentiles, that you may bring salvation to the ends of the earth.’” 48 And when the Gentiles heard this, they began rejoicing and glorifying the word of the Lord, and as many as were appointed to eternal life believed. 49 And the word of the Lord was spreading throughout the whole region. 50 But the Jews incited the devout women of high standing and the leading men of the city, stirred up persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and drove them out of their district. 51 But they shook off the dust from their feet against them and went to Iconium. 52 And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Spirit.

30 Pisidian Antioch

30.1 Background

Miniature Rome - founded on 7 hills

Re-founded by Caesar Augustus after he shrunk the army to 28 legions, with a resulting increase in veterans. He gave land grants in Pisidian Antioch to retired soldiers.

Herod and Caesar shared the same worldview, but Herod was hemmed in by the territory of Israel

30.2 Geography

Founded 3C BC to protect major roads. Roman roads were critical for rapid movement of troops. In peacetime, roads provided rapid travel.

6BC Via Sebaste built between Pisidian Antioch and Perga (port city on the coast).

Paul likely took the Via Sebaste north at the beginning of first missionary journey, and travelled overland on the way back

30.3 History see

City founded by Antiochus I (Seulicid)

190 BC Battle of Magnasia

189BC Treaty of Apamea

131 BC Attelid

31BC Battle of Actium. Mark Anthony defeated by Octavian (soon to become Caesar Augustus).

61BC Julius Caesar comes to power. Civil war with Pompei, who is eventually assassinated in Egypt -> Julius Caesar increases in power.

59BC - Comet appears in sky - taken as a sign that Caesar is divine.

44BC - Julius Caesar assassinated by Brutus and Cassius. Octavian comes to power at age 18.

42BC - Senate proclaims Caesar divine

25 BC Caesar refounded 'Antioch towards Pisidian' as a Roman colony

30.4 Social mobility

Roman economy was founded upon slavery. Spartacus led a slave revolt in XXX. Emperor realized that social mobility would be necessary to give some hope to slaves and prevent another slave revolt. Manumission was the process of freeing a slave, in which the slave would become a client of the former owner. Urban slaves were better off than the rural poor (freeman) because of the protection of the patron. This gave more social mobility to Roman society compared with Greek society, where once a slave you were always a slave.

Early church considered all social classes equal in standing before God, which threatened the established social order of Rome.

30.5 Eastern Frontier

Eastern frontier was a threat to Rome, both from Jewish uprising in Israel and the Parthians. Herod was instrumental in defending eastern frontier.

40BC Parthians had installed Antigonus. Herod fled to Rome to ask for help. Herodian built as a memorial. Antonian fortress - Herod was friends with Mark Anthony. When Caesar Augustus defeated Mark Anthony in 30BC Herod went over to Augustus.

30.6 Revelations

Written to the persecuted church - Written in code so that the Romans wouldn't decipher. Written to a persecuted church to remind them that Jesus was still on the throne.

30.7 Hermeneutics

Proverbs =/= promises

30.8 Bible

Acts 13:14 Paul travels to P antioch

Acts 14:21 Preached gospel and returned to Antioch

Acts 16:16

Second missionary journey

30.9 Site

30.9.1 Temple to Caesar

100 columns and 2 levels. Propylon inscription recounts deeds of Caesar.

31 Hieropolis

Day 3 9/16

31.1 Geography

Lichus river valley - branch of Meander Interior road to Ephesus Holy city = Hieros + polis

31.2 History

200s BC Antiochus II (261BC - 246BC)

190BC Battle of Magnasia

189 Treaty of Apamea

133BC - Attelis III willed kingdom to Rome

17 AD earthquake (city is located over a seismic fault line)

60AD earthquake

Zenith in 2C BC and 3C BC with 80,000 inhabitants

31.3 Tomb scenes

Lazarus (John 11). Had been dead 4 days. People weren't considered dead until after 3 days.

Jesus weeps: feels the pain of death in Lazarus. Sin and death were joined since the Fall.

Resurrection: John 20. Mary thought he was the gardener.

God partners with humanity to bring wholeness

31.4 Signs of Jesus

- 1) Wedding at Cana John 2
- 2) Healing of official's son Jn 4:43
- 3) Healing of paralytic at Bethsaida Jn 5
- 4) Feeding 5000 John 6
- 5) Walking on water
- 6) John 9
- 7) Healing of Lazarus Jn 11
- 8) Resurrection of Jesus - a new reality. First day of the new week. First day of new life.

New tomb in which no one had been laid

Cross and tomb both in a garden

Theology required an empty tomb

Cor 15 - No hope without resurrection

Gardner redeems the garden

31.5 Garden of Eden

Sin destroys our relationships:

- With God
- With ourselves
- With others
- with Creation

John 18

Jesus crosses Kidron valley to go to a garden (no mention of Gethsemane).

(Gethsemane = oil + pressing)

John doesn't include "take this cup" or Judas. He wants the audience to know "there is victory in the garden"

Empty tomb represents more than just forgiveness of sins.

Eternal life doesn't just begin after we die. Restoration of all things means reconciling us to ourselves.

Exile in Babylon occurs because Israel did not give the land a Sabbath.

Jesus doesn't want to just forgive us for our brokenness.

Rev 22: Renewed heaven and earth.

End game is about Shalom

Discipleship in addition to salvation

31.5.1 Water = chaos = demonic

Red sea = sea parted

Jordan River = waters parted

Bethany beyond Jordan - Jesus redeems the Jordan river

Battle with chaos by the word (??)

John comes in the spirit of Elijah

Elijah leaves the earth at the Jordan

John channels Elijah - wearing skins, etc

Naaman ~ healing of lepers by Jesus

32 Martyrium of Philip

Built 4c/5C AD in honor of Philip, who was martyred 80sAD

Edict of Milan - Constantine made Christianity legal

Who was Philip

- 1) Philip the disciple
- 2) Philip the evangelist in Acts (who preaches to Ethiopian eunich)

John 1:43

Finding Philip, from Bethsaida (only recounted by John)

John

Turning to Philip

John xx:20

Greeks came to Philip in order to speak to Jesus

John 14:8-9

Philip said: "show us the father"

Apocrypha: Book of Philip

- Eye condition -> healed

Church grows in persecution and dies in complacency

Gap between expectations and reality => crisis of faith. eg "I can't believe in a God who would allow this to happen"

Modern technology increases our ability to predict the unknown

Life does not allow the same control as our phones

"Get thee behind me, Satan!" When we can die to our expectation, we can be open to his leading.

33 Laodicea

To Colossae and Laodicea and those I have not met

Epiphra - Pastor for Colossae

Mount Cadmis - Source of cold water

33.1 History

Village fortified in 260BC

Built by Antiochus II mid 3C BC

190 BC -> given to Attelid kingdom

17AD Earthquake

26AD Competed with 10 cities to become neokorus for Tiberius, who later chose Smyrna, citing a lack of finances in Laodicea for the project. As a result, the city made it a goal to make money.

60AD after earthquake, Laodicea refused Nero's aid in rebuilding (because of their wealth). Colossae was not given aid by Nero because they were considered "no longer important"

33.2 Economy

- 1) Banking center
- 2) Medical center specializing in ophthalmology. Eye salve collrium (sp?). Demontheses wrote an ophthalmology textbook
- 3) Athletics and Gladiatorial competition
- 4) Black wool - due to high lime content in water. Lime content meant that you might vomit after drinking the water.
- 5) Zeno family - "Throne City" of Plancia Magna, benefactress of XXXX

33.3 Geography

Hot water - hot springs of Hieropolis - brought healing Cold water - Colossae - cool and refreshing

I know your deeds (not “I know your faith” or “I know your theology”)

I wish you were hot or cold

You are good for nothing (vs Laodicea - “I don’t need a thing”)

Church began to take on ethos of the community/city.

When Nero did not provide funding for rebuilding of Colossae, Laodicea didn’t help.

So be zealous and repent

We have gotten good at confession (I am off the path) rather than repentance (returning to the path).

God loves repentance (cf David sins and then repents)

Imperatives:

- Hear
- Be zealous
- Repent

Roman soldiers had the right to knock on a door and come in to be garrisoned and supplied, and ask for clothing for colleagues.

“sup with you” = *Deipnon* (?) in greek

Multiple copies made of Revelation - each church sees the letters to the other churches, so that the group of churches can help them repent and can learn from each others’ mistakes

Laodicea was midway between Hieropolis and Colossae

34 Philadelphia

Day 4 9/17 at 16:30

34.1 Background

1 - “Gateway to the East” 2 - Promoted Hellenistic values

34.2 Culture and industry

Famous for grape production due to volcanic soil. Catacecaumene = “burnt land”

34.3 Religion

Patron saint - Dionysus

- God of wine
- God of the arts esp theater
- God of Spring Break

34.4 History

Founded by Attelis II (ruled 168-158 BC). Nicknamed Philadelphus because elder brother ruled Attelid kingdom (Eumenes II) before him from 197-159BC. In the 160s Attelis II made a trip to Rome, and Rome wanted him to overthrow his brother. Eumenes found out, and named his brother Philadelphus

- 133BC Attelis III wills empire to Rome
- 17AD earthquake decimated. People moved outside city for over a year due to aftershocks.
 - Tiberius suspended taxes for 5 years -> in gratitude, name of city is changed to Neocaesarea

- During Nero, name changed back to Philadelphia
- 60AD earthquake -> Vespasian provides \$ -> name changed to Flavia (his wife)
- 92 Domation edict: 505 of all farmland to be sown in grain. This was a problem for the local economy, and the soil would not support growing wheat.
- After Domitian's death -> name changed back to Philadelphia.

#Bible

I will make them my pillars -> my new name

Open door - a gateway that no one can shut.

Pillars - stability You have little power

I will write on (pillars) my new name

Rev 6:10

Is Jesus is gatekeeper to new Jerusalem

Is 60:4-15 Children of oppressors will bow down before you. Then I will call you XXX of my name

Is 45:14 When the bow

Is 49:23 Kings shall be your

I will make (synagogue of satan) bow and acknowledge that I have loved you.

Is 62:1-2 vindication: You will be called by a new name which the mouth of the Lord shall bestow

34.5 Jews and Christians

Jews were granted an exemption to cult worship (ie sacrificing meat to idols), and had to pay a tax

Jews later told the Romans that the Christians were not part of them.

Jews believed that the Christian faith was a farce.

I will keep you from the hour of the test for the whole world (=unrighteous??)

Only imperative: "hold fast" = Krato eg grab onto a fishing net in the middle of a storm.

All Greek words come from 7 trades

I am coming soon =/= a rapture

I thess 4 Will be aught up together in the cloud. Meet = apantasis. When the emperor comes to the city, the citizens go out to meet him and escort him into the city.

Dan 7:13

Dan 7:11 - boastful word: Beast slain

35 Aphrodisia

Friday Morning September 17th

City of Marble (1 mile from marble quarry)

Origins as small village until 2nd century BC Growth as artisans began to move from Pergamum Incorporated as city in 1st century BC 44BC Julius Caesar assassinated - Brutus and Cassius were responsible - Octavian and Mark Anthony and _____ form triumvirate - Civil war between Octavian and Mark Anthony vs Brutus and Cassius - Aphrodisia supported Octavian - Labienus and his followers supported Brutus and Cassius - Labienus pillories Aphrodisia for their support of Octavian 42BC Octavian and Mark Anthony defeat Brutus and Cassius (who commit suicide) 39BC Mark Anthony grants free city status to Aphrodisia for their loyalty to him 30BC Mark Anthony commits suicide after defeat by Octavian (Caesar Augustus) Inscription in wall from Julius Caesar: "I love this city and take it as my own"

35.1 Origin Stories

Homer writes Iliad and Odyssey, which forms origin story for Greece Virgil writes Aeneid, which connects Greek and Roman origin stories.

Story starts when Troy is burning (same scene as end of Iliad). Aphrodite (Venus) is father of Aeneas

35.1.1 Emperors connected with Aphrodite in their own origin story

Emrit - 2 miles outside of Caesari Philippi

- Temple to Caesar Augustus
- Status of Venus present => Emperor identified with Aphrodite

35.2 Temple to Aphrodite

Tetrapylon - Gateway into sanctuary - built 200AD

Temenos - Courtyard Proneos - Front part Neos - Holy of Holies

36 Museum

Obelisk - 125 different names of those providing for those in need. Three categories of names:

- Jews (n=61)
- Proselytes (n=3) Gentiles who desire to convert to Judiasm. [Wikipedia](#)
 - (Baptized)
 - Circumcision
 - Kosher laws
- God-Fearing (n=52)

Gentiles who want to worship Yaweh but don't want to adopt culture of Jews. [Link](#)

Acts 13:16

So Paul stood up, and motioning with his hand said: "Men of Israel and you who fear God, listen.

Acts 17:4

And some of them were persuaded and joined Paul and Silas, as did a great many of the devout Greeks and not a few of the leading women.

Acts 17:17

So he reasoned in the synagogue with the Jews and the devout persons, and in the marketplace every day with those who happened to be there.

36.1 Sebastieon

36.1.1 Aphrodite

- Goddess of Love. Usually depicted as sensual
- Mother Goddess. Statue found in Temple to Aphodite portrays her as mother goddess (in full length dress)

Sebastos = venerable one = Greek version of Augustus

The Sebasteion, excavated in 1979-81, was a grandiose temple complex dedicated to Aphrodite and the Julio-Claudian emperors. Its construction stretched over two generations, from c. AD 20 to 60, from the reign of Tiberius to that of Nero. The complex was paid for by two prominent Aphrodisian families. It consisted of a Corinthian temple and a narrow processional avenue (90 x 14 m) flanked by two portico-like buildings, each three-storeyed (12 m high), with superimposed Doric, Ionic, and Corinthian orders. These North and South Buildings, which defined the processional avenue, carried marble reliefs in their upper two storeys for their whole length. The reliefs were framed by the columnar architecture so that the two facades looked like closed picture-walls. Some 200 reliefs were required for the whole project, and more than 80 were recovered in the excavation. They featured Roman emperors, Greek myths, and a series of personified ethnē or 'nations' of Augustus' world empire, from the Ethiopians of eastern Africa to the Callaeci of western Spain[link](#)

Temple to Aphrodite and Julio-Claudian emperors (except Caligula)

Reliefs recounted the deeds of the emperor.

Poema = Work of poetry

Eph 2:8-10

For by grace you have been saved through faith. And this is not your own doing; it is the gift of God, not a result of works, so that no one may boast. For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus for good works, which God prepared beforehand, that we should walk in them.

We are God's Sebastien - recounting of his deeds

"Do you know what it means that you are God's workmanship? What is art? Art is beautiful, art is valuable, and art is an expression of the inner being of the maker, of the artist. Imagine what that means. You're beautiful, you're valuable, and you're an expression of the very inner being of the Artist, the divine Artist, God Himself. You see, when Jesus gave Himself on the Cross, He didn't say, "I'm going to die just so you know I love you." He said, "I'm going to die, I'm going to bleed, for your splendor. I'm going to re-create you into something beautiful. I will turn you into something splendid, magnificent. I'm the Artist; you're the art. I'm the Painter; you're the canvas. I'm the Sculptor; you're the marble. You don't look like much there in the quarry, but I can see. Oh, I can see!" Jesus is an Artist!" And you beloved are His crowning achievement, His masterpiece!¹

How do our lives (and deeds) communicate a message about who God is?

I Peter - Living stones built together

¹Tim Keller

Your body is a temple

I Cor 3

I Cor 6

=> Allow God to shape your life

36.2 Kingdom of Priests

37 Parable of the Vineyard

Saturday Sept 18th morning

Ancient vineyards run along the ground. In contact with ground, grapes can become contaminated with fungus (grape smut?) which stunts their growth. Modern vineyards raise the vines off the ground on wires. In ancient times, if the Vinedresser found contaminated grapes, he would lift up the vines or a rock or on a forked stick in order to allow the sun to dry off the grapes and combat grape fungus.

Every branch that bears fruit the vinedresser prunes, that it will bear more fruit.

Pruning cuts off leaves

- Allows sun to get to other leaves
- Permits directing nutrients

We need to trim the good things in our lives to make energy for the great things. Requires being clear on who you are and what you are uniquely called (and gifted) to do

“Good to Great” - Enemy of great is good

Brad Gray - As a candidate for a pastoral job - re-wrote the job description and handed it back go search committee.

Look at how many times Jesus disappointed those around him (people he didn't heal). “That is why I have been sent”

Jesus's imperative : **remain in me**

37.1 What are the fruit

37.1.1 Good works

You will know (false prophets) by their fruit - Can bramble bear good fruit?

37.1.2 Fruits of the Spirit

Character as evidenced by good deeds

37.2 John 15-17

Where do the events in these chapters take place?

John 14: Let us leave (Upper Room)

John 18 - Jesus left -> crossed the Kidron Valley Perhaps they left the Eastern Gate after leaving the temple, which would lead to the garden (also referred to as Gethsemane).

37.2.1 Did John 15-17 take place in the Temple

Temple was left unlocked during passover (so that the Messiah wouldn't be locked out of the temple)

Jesus was the new Moses

-

38 Sardis Site

Saturday Sept 18th morning

Large site

38.1 History

Founded 1400BC - Center of Lydian Kingdom

Roman province of Asia established 129BC

First community to start dying wool, created dice,

38.1.1 Heraclids Dynasty.

Earliest rulers: Heraclids - ruled 505 years and 55 kings

Last Heraclids king: Croesus - had beautiful wife. Demanded that his chief bodyguard see her naked to know how beautiful she was. Croesus hid Gyges in his wife's bedroom. Wife discovers Gyges and proposes two options to address her dishonor: Gyges would kill himself, or would kill her husband (for arranging dishonor), and she would marry him. Gyges would become first of Mermnad dynasty.

38.1.2 Mermnad Dynasty

Herodotus - Mermnad rulers invented coinage

Mining gold in Pactolis river runs between Acropolis and Necropolis

38.2 Battle with Cyrus

Croesus - Mermnad king. Ten years into his rein, debates challenging Cyrus (leader of Persian empire).

Inquires of Oracle at Delphi. Was told: *If you cross the River Hales, a great kingdom would be destroyed*

547BC Croesus crosses the Haley river at Cappodicia to fight Cyrus. Battle ends in stalemate. The end of the fighting season ends, Croesus dismissed the allied armies and heads back to Sardis. Cyrus pursues Croesus and asks the allied armies to join him, ,but they refuse.

October 546BC Cyrus besieged Sardis for one year.

Persian solder observed a Lydian soldier climb down the wall to retrieve a dropped helmet. This observation identified an ara of vulnerability in the wall. A small team was able to breach the wall at night, and open the city gates.

334BC - Sardis remained in Persian control

Conquered by Alexander the Great

220 BC - Celucid king in control

Achaeus usurped authority and rebelled against Antiochus III and pronounced himself king.

Antiochus III besieged Sardis for two years.

Soldier named Lagoris noted that in an area long the wall where dead animals were thrown over the wall, the vultures perched on the wall without being disturbed, meaning that area was not guarded.

39 Thyatira

Smallest city, but longest letter

(Why site a city where there is no natural protection?)

3000 BC Lydian town - located near site of Lydian worship of sun god Tyrimnus.

Seleucus I formed a military colony with Macedonian soldiers in 300s BC

190 BC Seleucids under Antiochus III held the city.

188 BC Treaty of Apamea resulted in control by the Attelids

129BC incorporated into Roman province of Asia

39.1 Culture

Manufacturing city: Bronze working, baking, shoemaking

Acts 16:19 Paul by the river... Woman Lydia from Thyatira, craftsman of purple cloth. (Location would have been Phillipi)

39.2 Deeds

Word used 5x in letter: ergon $\epsilon\rho\omega\nu$

James

Faith - pistos ς ς Works - ergon $\epsilon\rho\omega\nu$

39.3 Food sacrificed to idols

Acts 15:29

that you abstain from what has been sacrificed to idols, and from blood, and from what has been strangled, and from sexual immorality. If you keep yourselves from these, you will do well. Farewell.”

Acts 21:25

But as for the Gentiles who have believed, we have sent a letter with our judgment that they should abstain from what has been sacrificed to idols, and from blood, and from what has been strangled, and from sexual immorality.”

40 Pergamum

\$ /pi /epsilon /rho /gamma /alpha /mu /omega /sigma \$ = Height / Elevation / Citadel

40.1 Geography

Located on a mountain - easily defensible. No steep cliff like Sardis. Not a port city.

40.2 History

Settlement 8th Century BC

Controlled by Alexander the Great.

After Alexander's death, empire split among Alexander's generals.

- Lysimachus takes control of western Asia
- Seleucus takes control of territories to the East
- Seleucus attacks Lysimachus in order to expand his territory
- Philetaerus - steward of the city of Pergamum for Lysimachus: Switches sides to Seleucus just prior to the battle for Pergamum.
- Seleucus wins and rewards Philetaerus, who became wealthy, and first Attalid king.

212 BC: Alliance of Rome and Attalus I attacks Antiochus III the Great and wins. Rome allows Attalus to keep control of Pergamum (as they were skeptical that they could control a large modern city.)

190 BC Battle of Magnesia

189 BC Treaty of Apamea

133 BC Antiochus III wills his empire to Rome

129 BC Pergamum becomes capital of province of Asia. 150 AD Ephesus is on the ascendancy and overshadows Pergamum. Ephesus has a port, which Pergamum does not.

31 BC Octavian defeats Mark Anthony at Battle of ____.

29 BC Pergamum asks Octavian to allow it to be the first city to construct a temple for emperor worship. Octavian agrees, on the condition that temples are also constructed at Ephesus and Nicaea to Roma and Julius Caesar.

40.2.1 Ius Gladii

Only Roman governors and the emperor were given the right of the sword, meaning the power to execute capital punishment. Roman legionnaires carried a double-edged sword. Emperor carried a pear-shaped sword (to emphasize their power of life and death). Usual mechanism of capital punishment was the gladiatorial ring.

40.3 Throne of Satan

Sites of pagan worship in Pergamum which might be candidates for “Throne of Satan”:

40.3.1 Temple of Zeus

Located in Bergama museum in Berlin. Built around 170 BC by Eumenes II

Rev 8:34 Incense smoke rising off the altar

Tabernacle - 12 loaves of show-bread, which are exchanged every Sabbath. Priests eat bread after Shabbat -> “I provide for you”

40.3.2 Temple of Athena

Second largest library in the ancient world

Julius Caesar invaded Alexandria and destroyed the library. Mark Anthony plunders library in Pergamum in retaliation.

Built in 36 BC as first temple.

Athena was goddess of wisdom (cf “I am the way, the truth, and the life”)

40.3.3 Trajan Temple

Built 98-117 AD for emperor worship.

Original temple built in 29 BC for emperor worship has not been found.

26 AD 2nd temple built for Smyrna - Neokorus for Tiberius. This means that for 50 years, Pergamum was leading site for emperor worship.

98 AD Trajan selects Pergamum as site for construction of temple for emperor worship. Platform for temple supported by Arches (similar to arches supporting Herod's Temple in Jerusalem)

40.3.4 Letter to Ephesians

Ephesians 1-3: Christian identity. Chapters 4-6: Christian behavior. Fits pattern of identity -> Calling -> Conduct.

Our fight is not against flesh and blood.

Armour of God is defensive

Roman soldiers forbidden to protect hamstrings (so that they would not be comfortable running away from the enemy).

Need a community to stand firm similar to how Roman soldiers were able to create a strong defensive position by interlocking their shields ("tortus")

Right relationships » Right behaviors

40.3.5 Temple to Dionysus

Theater began in ancient Greece

Springtime festival: Dionysus was resurrected from the dead each spring. Dionysus was patron saint of theater and the arts.

Patron deity of arts and theater

Tragedy and Comedy

Pantomime - One actor plays all roles. Suggestive and sensual

Mime - Dialog without masks. Crude. Very popular. Could be performed in the agora

Eph 5

Not even a hint of ... or coarse jesting

Symposia = “drinking together”

Convivium - less sexual and more intellectual

Roman relationships were all transactional

XXX Room - Stone couches with pillows. Women and boys available

Libation - drink offering to the Gods

Thomas Cahill - fragment of 4C BC comedy which comments on how a symposia typically progresses

Jesus - I am the resurrection and the life (reference to Dionysus)

Jn 6

I am the living bread which comes down from heaven. Unless you eat my flesh and drink my blood, you have no part of me. Your ancestors ate the manna in the desert and died.

“Room clearing speech”

John doesn’t include Last Supper

Took | Blessed | Broke | Gave - these elements were in the feeding of the 5,000

Podium Hall - could accommodate 70 worshippers of Dionysus. Meat (sacrificed on altar) and wine - body and blood of Dionysus.

40.4 Demeter = Ceres

Goddess of grain

Jn

I am the bread of life.

Only way to get into sanctuary is to be sprinkled with the blood of piglets.

Included an altar to an unknown god.

40.5 Aescylupian

Aescylapius - Father is Apollo. God of inspiration.

Epiparis

Most famous hospital in ancient world

Snakes - symbol of regeneration (they shed their skin)

If healed -> Can commission terra cotta body parts

Library

Stoa = Covered colonnade

Sacred Spring

Galen - practiced at Pergamum

Pythia - Oracle to speak to people for treatment regimens from gods

Soter = savior